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POLITICALLY CORRECT LANGUAGE

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Declaration

I hereby declare that this diploma thesis is completely my own work and that I used only the sources listed in the bibliography.

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“Transcend political correctness and strive for human righteousness.”

Anthony J. D'Angelo

I. INTRODUCTION

Language is a powerful tool that shapes the way we embrace the world. Just as a knife may be used to carve a piece of art or to hurt another being, language may be used in both ways: to help or destroy. And often it can be much sharper than any knife.

The goal of my diploma thesis is to focus on a particular tool of language – political correctness (PC) – a tool with a long history and doubtful tangible contributions. To expand the use of my metaphor, any tool may turn rusty. Because of its controversy, this applies to PC more than to other language strategies. It certainly is helpful to replace ‘Mrs.’ or ‘Miss’ with ‘Ms.’, which is much fairer because it does not bear the notion of martial status just as ‘Mr.’ does not include this piece of information. On the other hand, instead of avoiding injustice, it can be easily used to avoid responsibility and the reality of the world around us. One may say, for instance, that he or she is not *lazy* but *motivationally dispossessed*, which is obviously a humorous example. However, one may replace the term *juvenile delinquent* with *child at risk*, which is already a significant shift of responsibility for improper behaviour from the person who behaves in an inappropriate way to the unfavourable surroundings.

My question is whether a line can be drawn between the ‘good’ use and the ridiculous one and whether the division line is the same in the Czech language. Therefore I have chosen a literary piece that has never been translated to Czech and which is often presented as an example of ridiculousness politically correct language (PCL)

may bring, mostly because this book is deliberately written with the purpose of showing the far edge this language use may lead to.

Drawing on my experience with commercial translations, which I did as a part-time job while studying at the faculty, I have translated five stories from *Politically Correct Bedtime Stories* by James Finn Garner. I did so with permission granted by the author, with an honest intention on my mind and the best I could.

II. THEORETICAL PART

1. POLITICAL CORRECTNESS

1.1 Definition of political correctness

The term of political correctness denotes avoidance of certain words or phrases in the field of public affairs and particularly politics. Among others, the former includes media and branches where the professions in question, such as teachers, work and influence greater number of people and thus serve as a model of the proper language. Beyond avoidance of the disputable terms, such terms are also replaced with other terms, euphemisms.
The reason for omitting or substituting these terms is that they carry offensive connotations, particularly the terms representing certain racial, sexual, cultural or other minority groups. It is believed that avoidance or replacement of these offensive terms leads to a change in attitude towards those minority groups. This is called language planning and it will be discussed in detail in one of the following chapters, as well as at the actual assets the usage of politically correct language brings. But first, it is necessary to mention the roots of political correctness, when, where and why did it appear.

1.2 History of political correctness

The term of political correctness comes from The United States of America. It was there where it developed into the contemporary meaning and where it gained the greatest amount of acceptance and publicity.
The earliest mention of the term comes from the Supreme Court decision in the case of Chisholm vs. Georgia in 1793. It had a different meaning from the one we are familiar with today, though.

It suggested that using the term *The United States* instead of *the People of the United States* did not correlate with the way the ideals and goals of politics of The United States were generally seen and defined by then. In other words, it said that the former term was not politically correct as the state was there for the people rather than the other way round.

“The states, rather than the People, for whose sakes the States exist, are frequently the objects which attract and arrest our principal attention. (...) Sentiments and expressions of this inaccurate kind prevail in our common, even in our convivial, language. Is a toast asked? 'The United States,' instead of the 'People of the United States,' is the toast given. This is not politically correct.” (The Supreme Court of the USA decision 1793)

One of the first appearances of the term in the last century can be found in the autobiography of American Senator Robert La Follette. Describing the education he got, he says: “In those days we did not so much get correct political and economic views, for there was then little teaching of sociology or political economy worthy of the name, but what we somehow did get, and largely from Bascom, was a proper attitude toward public affairs. And when all is said, this attitude is more important than any definite views a man may hold.” (La Follette 1913:27-28)

The way the author understands the term is that certain views and opinions are more suitable for use in the field of public affairs than others, which is already closer to the concept we know from The United States in the 1990’s.

The next quotation I use comes from Morton (2002), first published in 1936. Here again the adjective phrase denotes a term that is wiser to use in politics than another one: “To use such words would have been equivalent to calling his audience 'slaves and robbers'. But Galatians, a term that was politically correct, embraced everyone under Roman rule, from the aristocrat in Antioch to the little slave girl in Iconium.” (Morton 2002:244)

The contemporary understanding of the term appeared in the 1980's and it's evolution is marked by changing shifts between acceptance of the term as language usage carrying serious and useful purpose and criticism of a term denoting language use that is more interested in shape than important matters. The term political correctness is first known to be used in some way related to its contemporary usage as part of Marxist-Leninist vocabulary to describe the Party Line following the Russian Revolution of 1917.

By the 1980s the expression had an ironic tinge, denoting someone who was over-zealous to left-wing political causes. The term gained popularity as part of a critique aimed at teaching methods at colleges in the United States. "In a commencement address at the University of Michigan in 1991, President George H. W. Bush spoke out against administrators and academics who would declare certain topics off-limits, certain expressions off-limits, even certain gestures off-limits" (Glassner 1999). Conservatives proclaimed that academic circles, mostly left-wing oriented, tried to change words and phrases and thus carried out social engineering.

In the late 1990s the use of the term diminished and even though it can be often found in a comedy or satire context, and it is also used to criticize the left, it is still used nowadays.

1.4 Criticism of political correctness

PC is criticized by some politicians and linguists because it limits the language choice and speech freedom. It certainly cannot be denied that political correctness bears a certain degree of resemblance to censorship. Let us look into this matter in more detail.

The Oxford Advanced Learner's Dictionary defines *censorship* this way: "act or policy of censoring books, etc." Since books were a major medium to convey thoughts for centuries, it is quite understandable that books are mentioned here in spite of the fact

that censorship may be applied to any other medium. I would like to point out the occurrence of the words ‘act’ and ‘policy’. Censorship may be an act of an individual or a group of individuals who remove certain parts from a text. But this person or persons usually do not base the decision on their own judgement, but act as an executive of a certain ‘policy’. That is the very power that decides what is ‘acceptable’ and what is not. But what are the motives of this power?

Further examination of the verb *to censor* reveals that it means “to examine or remove parts from something”. This is not very helpful in search for the motive of such a removal. More can be found in definition of the noun *censor*: “person authorized to examine books, films, plays, letters, etc and remove parts that are considered indecent, offensive, politically unacceptable or (esp in war) a threat to security.” The word ‘authorized’ makes it clear that the person has a permission to censor from the authorities, in other words the group wielding the power. Use of passive voice suggests that the scope of unacceptable thoughts or language is left out (or is presented to be left out) in the public interest. Passive voice also leaves it to the reader to supplement the missing subject with anything he or she thinks suitable. Reversing the voice, we could create sentences like ‘decent citizens consider something indecent, offensive, etc’ or ‘Christians consider...’ or ‘the dictatorship considers...’ It was not my aim to offend anyone and I picked these examples at random to show that the range of understanding of what is decent or offensive and what is not, is very wide. It is important to realize that censorship is a limitation of certain use of language, whatever the motive is, and there is usually a threat of penalty enforced on the individuals who do not omit this language use.

Also the similarity in the expression register of *censorship* and *political correctness* is apparent. In both cases, the same or similar words are employed, e.g. ‘offensive’ or ‘politically unacceptable’, which could easily be a synonym of ‘politically incorrect’. Basing

their understanding on this logical construct and register resemblance, one could readily agree that the principles of both, *political correctness* and *censorship* are the same, simply put *to remove certain parts from language*. However, this is a similarity in means, not rational motives for using those means. This is where, in my opinion, the criticism of political correctness is unconvincing.

To explain this better, I have to bring the issue to the brink of the absurd. One may say that the freedom of an individual is limited by the freedom of another individual. We are not absolutely free in what we do and say, there are certain roles that we are taught to accept and that we do accept because human society is based on them as well as on mutual co-operation. If the most of people didn't accept their social roles, or didn't try to co-operate, the society we know would not exist.

A part of a social role is a particular language use. To give an example, parents make it clear to their offspring that it is forbidden to use the f. word (or any other vulgar word) in front of a teacher or the grandparents. In the strictest comprehension, it is basically a limitation of language use, just as censorship and political correctness. I strongly doubt that any of those critics of PC who are parents would consider this limitation ethically unjustified. But the means, not motives, are the same.

As I said, this example is brought to the edge of the absurd. However, I was aiming to show that regulating language is an everyday practice and it is only the motive of such limitation that varies.

Now I got to the question I posed in the prologue: where is the line between the 'good' usage and the 'bad' one. The line between the two uses is a line between the acceptance and refusal of political correctness by the public. The conclusion may sound a bit cynical, but I have come to believe that this line, and where it lies, is a cause of a struggle for power between several groups with different motives. There are those:

- who genuinely believe that PC is a justifiable attempt to bring more fairness to those whose status is confined by language use
- who genuinely believe that PC is confining the language they use (limiting the freedom of speech)
- who use PC as a cloak they may take on where there is an advantage in it
- who fear PC would deprive them of their superior and privileged status the current language use brings them

Because of this labyrinth of motives, political correctness is such a controversial issue and there is such a wide gap between its advocates and critics.

It would be very interesting to see a map of this labyrinth, but I posses no means to draw it. Beyond, if it was so easy, someone would have certainly done it before me.

2. LANGUAGE AND POWER

2.1 All languages are created equal

"All men are created equal", sometimes modified to "All people are created equal" to comply with the principles of PC, is the main idea of democracy. As Jefferson (1776) proclaimed, this is a self-evident truth. The reality is, however, that not all people are equal in the beginning of the twenty-first century, not all people share the same amount of power or privileges even in many democratic states, which proclaim equality to be their foundation stone.

Since language is a part of an individual's identity, can one say that all languages are created equal? Just as in the case of the above mentioned quotation, it is certainly a self-evident fact that they are. Nevertheless, the reality is different from this enlightened ideal. The language we speak is one of the markers of the social status we have. If there was one generally accepted pan-language, language probably would not be a means of exerting power of one group over another. This is not the case, however.

Although *power* and *power relationships* constituted and maintained through means of language are the paramount issue to the topic of PC, and therefore they are more or less dealt with and mentioned in connection with the particular questions in all chapters of the thesis, it is essential to identify *power* first, the way people use language to exercise and keep power, who are the groups that wield power and what is their motivation. These are the goals of this chapter.

2.2 The link between power and language

The Oxford Advanced Learner's Dictionary describes *language* in the broad meaning as "a system of sounds, words, patterns, etc used by humans to communicate thoughts and feelings." There is no mention of power; the important piece of information, which will be needed later, is that language is used to share information.

In the beginning of his treatise on power and language, Fowler (1985) says that "power is the ability of people and institutions to control the behaviour and material lives of others." Once again, this is a very broad characterization and there is no obvious connection with language. This link can be found in his definition of *power relationships*, which may take on an inexhaustible number of forms, e.g. boss vs. employee, parent vs. child, etc. Fowler (1985) contends: "These power relationships are not natural and objective; they are artificial, socially constructed intersubjective realities." This concept of perceiving reality is recognised by other linguists, too. As Fowler remarks, Berger and Luckman (1976) even chose the term *social construction of reality* for the title of their book that was pursuing this topic. Further on, Fowler (1985:61) remarks that language plays an important role as a major mechanism in this process of social construction: "It is an instrument for consolidating and manipulating concepts and relationships in the area of power and control." The link between power and language is obvious now. Those who control the perception of reality control the power originating from it as well.

The number of particular forms of *power relationships* is vast so I am listing only a few of those connected with language more apparently than others as an example. One type may be a subordination of one language to another. English has such a firm position in today's world that it is believed to be necessary for one to be a member of the world community and as such it automatically has power. "It also is a symbol, which can be

manipulated to the aggrandizement of some and detriment of others." (Kachru and Nelson 1996:88)

Another example may be an attempt to create or maintain hegemony of a language within the nation as a means of unification. "Linguistic hegemony is achieved when dominant groups create a consensus by convincing others to accept their language norms and usage as standard or paradigmatic. Hegemony is ensured when they can convince those who fail to meet those standards to view their failure as being the result of the inadequacy of their own language." (Wiley 1996:113)

Although I have been concerned with the relationship between *power* and *language* in this chapter, it needs to be pointed out that other aspects such as "ideologies, cultural values and belief systems are closely linked to power." (Freeman and McElhinny 1996:220) It is, however, disputable whether those are more a result of the social construction process or a means of maintaining the privileged status. It seems both may be true to some extent.

2.3 Language planning

The relationship between *language* and *power* has been covered in the previous chapter. In this one, it is my aim to focus on methods through which power is achieved and who those groups that influence language are.

The use of language is shaped by the person's surroundings and any person may contrariwise influence language through selection of their means of expression or coining new ones. The impact of an individual on the language is relatively small, however. The most important changes on a large scale come from authorities such as writers, media and those who wield power. These people or institutions are called *language strategists* by Weinstein (1979) and the means they employ is referred to as *language planning*.

The International Encyclopedia of Linguistics defines *language planning* as follows: "A deliberate, systematic and theory-based attempt to solve communication problems of a community by studying the various languages or dialects it uses, and developing a policy concerning their selection and use; also sometimes called language engineering or language treatment. Corpus planning deals with norm selection and codification, as in the writing of grammars and the standardization of spelling; status planning deals with initial choice of language, including attitudes toward alternative languages and the political implications of various choices." (Bright 1992:108)

Wiley (1996) further remarks on the two described types of language planning: *status planning* is linked to the official recognition the authorities attribute to various languages, particularly in the case of minority languages, and to the authoritative attempts to extend or restrict language use in various contexts. This includes the designation of the language of instruction in schools, decisions regarding whether and in which languages bilingual ballots may be used or the language allowed for contact with the official institutions.

Status planning is also concerned with varieties within one language. "Historically, the creation of a standard language often begins with the selection of a regional or social variety – usually a written variety – that provides a base language for grammatical refinement and vocabulary. This initial choice confers privilege upon whose speech and writing most closely conform to the newly selected standard." The variation chosen as the standard is often associated with the regions where power centres are located, e.g. the area around London. This choice "results in what is usually called the *proper* or *correct* variety or is sometimes called the *preferred* or *power* variety. All these terms indicate that the standard is more valued than other varieties." (Wiley ibid:109) Note also the term *Received Pronunciation*, the variety of British pronunciation used in mass media and in teaching English in the

Czech Republic, where the term *received* means *normal*, *reputable* or *proper* here.

Status planning is interesting as it touches the issue of PC. It may, but does not necessarily have to, be of a restrictive character. The role of language as an identifying feature of a group or individual is not underestimated by the elite (i.e. state). The nineteenth century in Europe and its raise of national consciousness was connected with understanding language as one of the characteristic attributes of a nation, which had an important, integrating role at the costs of language minorities. The history of Bohemia, Moravia and Silesia within the Austrian Empire is more than an eloquent example for that matter. However, the language is not an attribute necessary to define a nation nowadays.

There are countries where the language diversity is understood as a part of the nation heritage. Pattanayak (1989:125), speaking of India, contends: "Many languages are like petals of a lotus. Many languages form a national mosaic. If some petals wither and fall off or if some chips are displaced from the mosaic, then the lotus and the mosaic look ugly. With the death of the languages the country will be poorer."

However, as Wiley (1996:125) remarks, many European and postcolonial states have used linguistic unification as a means of promoting national unification. "In societies where the majority of the population is monolingual, as in many Anglophone countries including the United States, there is often an underlying assumption that monolingualism – especially in English – represents an ideal nature state, whereas multilingualism represents a temporarily abnormal condition" (Wiley ibid:105)

It seems to me that one of the goals of PC is to shift *status planning* towards promoting a wider acceptance of different variations within a language (i.e. Afro-American English) and of the languages of the minorities. This corresponds with the two kinds of rights associated with language: "(1) the right to freedom from

discrimination on the basis of language(s); and (2) the right to use one's language in the activities of communal life." (Macías 1979)

Even though *status planning* is linked to PC, this link is more obvious with *corpus planning*. Cooper (1989:31) offers this definition of this type of planning: "activities such as coining new terms, reforming spelling, adopting a new script. It refers to the creation of new forms, the modification of old ones, or the selection from alternative forms in the spoken or written form." According to Wiley (1996), *corpus planning* may include attempts to define or reform the standard language by changing or introducing forms in spelling, pronunciation, vocabulary, and grammar. "Efforts to rid languages of gender bias are also examples of corpus planning." (ibid:108)

The conception of PC as a kind of *language planning* is shown on examples of the neologism *herstory* or *womyn* as an alternative spelling for *women* later in chapter 3.3. For now, the logical question of who are the agents managing *language planning* will be pursued.

Another definition of *language planning* (LP) may be helpful: "Organized activity (private or official) which attempts to solve language problems within a given society, usually at the national level. ... LP is usually conducted according to a declared program or a defined set of criteria, and with a deliberate goal by officially appointed committees or bodies, by private organizations, or by prescriptive linguists working on behalf of official authorities. Its object is to establish norms (primarily written) which are validated by high social status; oral forms connected with these written standards follow." (Jahr 1992) According to the first part of this definition, *language planning* seems to be a useful activity that helps the user of the language solve communication problems. In contrast with that, the second part marks official authorities as the source of the activity and mentions the norms they are trying to establish to be of a high social status.

It is not enough to establish valued standards. They have to be maintained, too. Those who have the privileged status intend to keep it. “People – those with power, mostly – may behave as if these (power) relationships are inevitable and immutable.” (Fowler 1985) But they are not inevitable and even though it is very difficult, PC is an attempt to breach the standard.

3. Inequity in language

3.1 The way the things are and the way they should be

The need for PC arisen from injustice of the real life. Since language is the way we understand and describe the world around us and for a long time it was not common for the powerful to reflect on the linguistic inequality forced on the weaker, this inequity is naturally mirrored in the language we have inherited from our ancestors, and as shown in the previous chapter language has been used to maintain this inequity. It has been only a relatively short period of time since such unjust disproportion started to be amended on a larger scale. In this chapter, it is my goal to focus on an area of life and language where egalitarian attitude is lacking and which is often discussed – men and women.

3.2 Men and women

This is one of the most debated examples of injustice in both language use and practical, real life consequences. As for the latter, I lack means to carry out a research and empiric analysis by my own means so the following available sources are used to show what the conditions are like in the Czech Republic.

Women in The Czech Republic have a legal right to the same job opportunities as men. However, they can be only scarcely found in the top positions or in politics and on average earn only 70 per cent of salary men are paid. So the situation is still far from being equal.

"Český trh práce se vyznačuje velmi silnou segregací oborů podle genderu. Zdravotnictví, obchod a služby jsou feminizované obory v nejnižší příjmové kategorii. Vedoucími pracovníky dokonce v těchto oborech jsou však mnohem častěji muži než ženy." (Čermáková 2002:23)

“The Czech labour market is characterized by segregation on basis of gender. Health service, stores and service are feminized areas with the lowest income. In spite of that, the leading positions are usually taken by men even in these areas.” (my translation)

Beyond that, the Czech society seemingly has not accepted the fact that women, when they have a full-time occupation, have also a second shift at home where they usually take care of most housework chores.

(Maříková 1996:18)

“Dalo by se předpokládat, že za této situace převezme muž na svá bedra část ženiných povinností. Výsledky výzkumů však dokazují, že pokud muž vůbec něco doma dělá, pokud vykonává některý z toho druhu domácích prací, které dříve náležely výhradně ženě, zaujímá spíše pozici pomocníka než náhradníka.“ (Maříková 1996:18)

“In these circumstances, one would expect the man to relieve the women of some of her responsibilities. Research results show, however, that if the man does anything at home, if he does a part of the housework that used to be on the woman’s shoulders, he takes on a role of a helper rather than replacing the woman in her role.” (my translation)

Another area where women have a weaker position than men is politics. Although this definitely is not a solely Czech phenomenon, a look at the representation of women in the top offices of the state administration may be helpful to illustrate the whole situation. I am leaving aside the role of the president, which is still quite unlikely to be held by a woman in at least a few upcoming years. Beyond that, based on the Czech constitution and in contrast to the USA or France, the president role is more of a representative character than of one having a great share of real political power, which may be more indicative of the condition of the Czech society, however.

A look at the representation of women in the body possessing the greatest amount of power, the government, will serve this purpose the best. According to *The Czech Statistical Office*, the numbers

from more than twenty past years clearly show that men are by a long way more often representing the whole population, in which the sexes have approximately the same proportion. That is obviously unjust.

	Štrougal 1981-1986	Štrougal 1986-1989	Pithart 1990-1992	Klaus I 1992-1996	Klaus II 1996-1998
Počet mužů	30	32	24	25	22
% mužů	100	100	96	100	95,6
Počet žen	0	0	1	0	1
% žen	0	0	4	0	4,4
Celkem	30	32	25	25	23

	Tošovský 1998	Zeman 1998-2002	Špidla 2002-2004	Gross 2004-2005
Počet mužů	15	19	15	16
% mužů	88,3	100	88,3	88,9
Počet žen	2	0	2	2
% žen	11,7	0	11,7	11,1
Celkem	17	19	17	18

Why such a huge gap can be found between men and women in politics, or why are women still deprived of equal job opportunities? These questions have no simple answers. There are two extreme opinions, first saying that it is a result of a patriarchal conspiracy against women, the other one stating that women naturally gravitate towards values such as managing family background and raising children rather than career aspiration and fight for power. The truth is probably somewhere in the middle and I am leaving the search for it to the more qualified than I am. For my work, the important fact is that such inequality exists in real life and now I

would like to focus on the same area from the linguistic point of view.

3.3 Men and Womyn

Womyn is a spelling alteration used by some feminists as a replacement for *women* that should remove the gender-marked part of the word, i.e. *men*. Similarly singular *womon* or *wom!n* have the *man* part excluded. There are more alternative spellings, but in all cases, pronunciation remains the same as with the regular words. The reason for this substitution is that the regular spelling empowers the image of a social and economical subordination of women and woman may be understood as a subcategory of man or human in general.

The right to choose an alternative spelling is grounded on belief that one may freely choose the terms denoting him or her rather than have them dictated by the long history of male supremacy. There is a solid historical background in the case of *woman*, which is discussed below, but there are also new spellings invented that are criticized for being based on incorrect assumptions. *Herstory* is an example of such made-up etymology. It symbolizes another angle of viewing history, from the women's perspective, which was omitted from history for a long time. Coining this term as opposed to *his story* is not etymologically correct, however, because the Greek origin *historia* has no connection with the English possessive pronoun *his*. Nevertheless, the term has rooted in English and is widely used now.

Because of the inclusion of the *man* part, possible evocation of an image of woman as a subcategory of man is undisputable nowadays. It hasn't always been the case, however. *The Concise Oxford Dictionary of English Etymology* says that "the prominent sense (of the word *man*) in Old English was 'human being'" (Hoad 1993). It was a gender-neutral term while there were other "words

distinctive of sex *wer* (male) and *wīf* (female), *wæp(n)man* and *wīfman*" (ibid). *Woman* developed from the last mentioned and it is in fact less gender biased than *werewolf*, for instance, which means 'half male man, half wolf'. Nevertheless, the present comprehension of the word *man* was brought by a shift towards an exclusive usage of the word for males in the fifteenth century during Hundred Years' War when term *man of arms* appeared (ibid). The meaning of *man* was broadened and women were excluded from the narrower sense of the word.

In the book I translated, the words *womon* and *womyn* were as a rule used to refer to the female characters in a politically correct way. These words posed a translational problem, however.

The Czech words *muž* and *žena* do not have the same conflict potential as their English counterparts. In contrast with them, the Czech expressions are of a different origin and there is even no noticeable similarity that could be indicative of subordinate status of the word for a female.

According to the dictionaries of Czech etymology, the word *muž* has the roots, just as English *man* or German *Mann*, in Indo-European language. Here is one quotation: "Praslovanský *mož* je pokračováním ie. **mangio-*, jež je odvozeninou příbuznou s **manu-*, které je v gót. *manna*, něm. *Mann*, angl. *man*. Další etymologizace ne zcela jistá, obvykle se spojuje s **men-*., tedy ‚myslící bytost'." (Machek 1997) So there is a connection with the Old English *man* as a human being, in contrary to not-thinking animals.

The original meaning of the word *žena* is not clear. Here I present two quotations: "Žena: všeslovanský indoevropský základ **g^{u}en*, souvisí s řeckým *gyne-*" (Holub and Lyer 1978) and "všeslovansky *žona*, rusky *žená*, srbochorvatsky *žèna*, staroslověnsky žena, praslovansky **žena* je příbuzné se staropruský *genna*, gótský *qino*, staroanglický *cwene* téhož významu, *cwēn* „královna" (odtud *queen* téhož významu), staroirský *ben* „žena", řecký *gyné* „žena, paní". Východiskem je indoevropský **g^{u}enā* (a další příbuzné podoby)." (Machek 1997)

Even though there is no trace of the original meaning of the word, both quotations clearly show that there is no connection with the word *muž* and since there is not the same etymological background, there is no way to translate the alternative spelling *womyn* to Czech either. Beyond that, both languages have a gender neutral term at disposal, i.e. *person* and *člověk*. Nonetheless, English seems to use this gender neutral expression less often than *man*, meanwhile it is common to use *člověk* in Czech to roof both sexes. As a result of this linguistic and cultural void, I used *ženy* and the reader of the bedtime stories is unfortunately deprived of a neologism that could not be created as there was no solid base to build it on.

3.4 Women and men: Swearing words

Apart from etymology, there is another interesting insight to the status of women and men within the language. It can be found in the field of oaths. No matter how low morally, this is a part of language that can be called anything but low in number of expressions. It is a flexible and fast developing part of language that may be considered an antipole of the politically correct language. Therefore it comes as a possible area of language where evidence of imbalance of the status of women and men could be found.

The issue of foul language is widely dealt with by Hughes (1993). In chapter named *Sexuality in swearing*, the author points out to an interesting fact: "...in contrast with the semantic field of *man*, there are remarkably few neutral terms for *woman*." (Hughes 1993:214) Later he adds: "As soon as one ventures beyond the central term *man*, one encounters a host of informal terms, such as *bloke*, *chap*, *fellow*, *cove* and *guy*." (ibid) Even though some of these terms are of disreputable origin, they all have a generally favourable connotation today. On the other hand, "virtually every term for

woman, formal or informal, has a strong moral or emotive overtone." (ibid) Beyond this observation, the author gives a figure of the historical evolution of categorization of women (vide infra).

Even though it isn't easy to trace foul language expressions back in the past and the figure, as a result, may not be a completely accurate description of reality, the disproportion between the number of the favourable and unfavourable terms is striking.

It has to be said the labels *favourable* and *unfavourable* are disputable. The context and intonation are very important and just as a favourable term might be used in an offensive manner, an unfavourable one may be used to express affection. The way I understand the author's *favourable* and *unfavourable* labels is that the former are referring to adorable, valued or desired attributes, e.g. sweetness, dignity, loveliness, virginity, intimacy, while the latter are referring to despised, feared or condemned attributes, e.g. adultery behaviour, promiscuity, sexually transmitted diseases, gossiping too much, etc. It is an interesting fact that these attributes are mainly valued from the men's point of view.

Figure of favourable and unfavourable terms for *woman* (Hughes 1993)

Date	Favourable	Unfavourable
	Lady	
900	Darling	
950		
1000	Maiden	Witch
1050		
1100		Whore
1150		
1200	Maid	Scold
1250	Dear	
1300	Damsel, Sweet, Sweeting	Quean, Lemman, Concubine, Strumpet
1350	Heart, Honey	Hag, Shrew, Virago, Popelot, Wench, Mare, Bitch, Paramour
1400	Poppet	Harlot, Slut, Filth, Mistress
1450		
1500		
1550	Treasure, Lamb, Nymph, Mouse, Coney	Gossip, Drab, Dell, Doxy, Trull, Mutton, Cat, Courtesan
1600	Angel, Goddess, Madonna	Moll, Punk, Bobtail, Doll, Wanton, Baggage, Goose, Bat, Vixen, Brach, Pigeon, Draggletail, Bun, Siren, Amazon, Minx, Boiled stuff
1650		Termagent, Dolly,

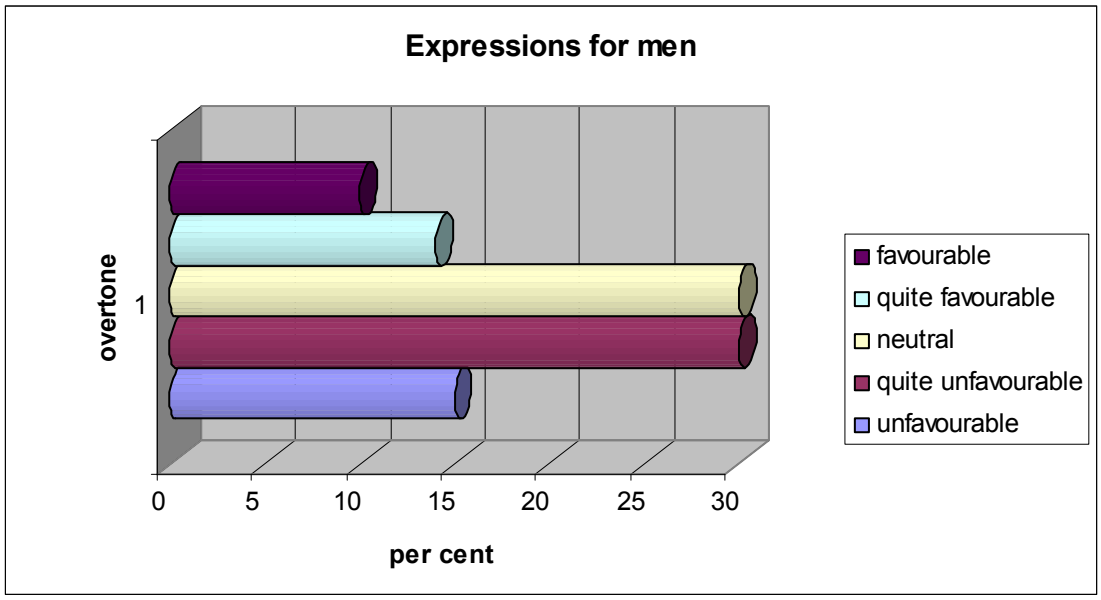
		Hussy, Trollop, Gipsy, Filly, Hen, Slattern, Inamorata, Puss, Coquette
1700		Brim, Fireship, Bawd, Bunter, Hoyden, Biddy, Traipse, Cow, Tabbycat, Kept-woman, Conveniency, Sow, Jilt
1750		Trumpery, Slammerkin
1800		Buttered bun, Pancake, Fuck (n.)
1850	Baby, Kitten	Blowen, Duck, Heifer, Sweetmeat, Hair, Scarlet woman
1900		Donah, Bird, Chicken, Tart, Cherry, Battleaxe, Vamp, Tramp, Femme fatale
1950	Sugar, Sweetie pie	Broad, Crow, Chick, Dish, Cookie, Cunt, Call-girl, Crumpet, Escort

I was interested in whether a similar difference could be found in the same semantic field in Czech. Tools such as thesaurus or corpus were of little avail here as these are both concerned with the standard version of the language; however, I surveyed them anyway.

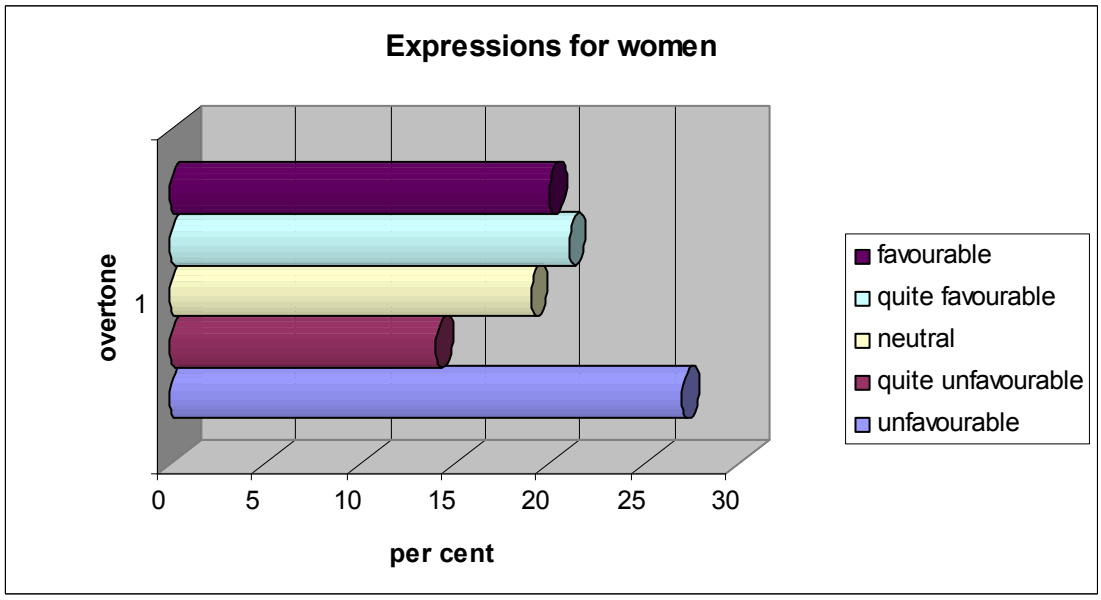
Slovník českých synonym offers these synonyms for *man*: "*muž* - 1. *mužský, chlap*. 2. *manžel*, 3. expr. *vojín, voják*" and "žena – 1. ženská, 2. manželka, choť. expr. stará. 3. paní" for *woman*. (Pala and Všianský 1994)

In spite of the fact that there was one neutral synonym for *man* and none for *woman*, and on the contrary, one more derogatory word for *wife*, the number of synonyms is limited in both cases so I decided to carry out a small research on my own. I set up a website where any visitor could submit any expression for a man or woman he or she knew. They were also required to value the amount of emotional strength of the term on a scale from 1 to 5, 1 being positive, number 3 neutral and number 5 marking a term of a negative connotation. The contributors were also required to state their sex.

The website was visited from 160 different computers, which means that approximately the same number of people saw it. This figure is not so important, however. These approximately 160 people, submitted 302 expressions, 125 for men and 177 for women. As shows the following graph, 10 per cent of the expressions for men were marked as favourable (pozitivní), 14 per cent as quite favourable (spíše pozitivní) and 30 per cent as neutral (neutrální). Another 30 per cent of terms were valued as quite unfavourable (spíše negativní) and 15 per cent as unfavourable (negativní).



The numbers for women were as follows: 27 per cent of favourable, 14 per cent of quite favourable, 19 per cent of neutral, 21 per cent of quite unfavourable and 20 per cent of unfavourable expressions.



There are several factors devaluating the absolute validity of the given figures that need to be mentioned. First of all, 160 people are too small a number to represent Czech native speakers as a whole. Second, overtone valuation of the expression was left to the contributor of the expression and since the sense of the moral and emotional strength of a term is open to a subjective interpretation

and may vary from an individual to individual as well as from a region to region, it would have been more accurate to allow all visitors to rate the expressions. A few terms were also submitted twice with only a small alteration in spelling. More weaknesses of the research will be discussed later in connection with particular outcomes.

Despite the above mentioned drawbacks, the figures roughly correspond with the two statements by Hughes, i.e. there are virtually no neutral expressions for women and there are more strongly marked expressions for women.

The figure of 30 per cent of neutral expressions for men compared to 19 per cent for women shows that the contributors knew more neutral terms to denote a man. Taking into account what Hughes says, one would expect the gap between the two figures wider, however. Having analysed the database of submitted expressions, my concluding interpretation is that some of the terms valued as neutral, e.g. *samice*, were valued so not because they are genuinely neutral, but were thought to be less offensive or praising compared to other submitted terms that were positively vulgar or flattering. These expressions, such as the mentioned *samice*, probably would not be used in a woman-to-woman or man-to-woman conversation as a neutral term to address one's conversational partner with. It is much more likely that we would find them in man-to-man conversations carrying an implicit reference to sexual attractiveness or unattractiveness of the woman in question or to other sexual attributes connected aspects. Therefore I believe that if these expressions were moved from the neutral category to one more befitting their actual emotional tint, the number representing the neutral terms would have been greatly reduced. In fact, having read all the submitted terms valued as neutral, there were, in my honest opinion, none that I would mark as neutral, with the exception of *paní*, *dívka*, *holka* and *ženská*, which can be used as an inoffensive alternative in most types of conversation, but on the other hand, these terms are also

indicative of either the martial status (*paní*) or age (*holka*) of the person.

Another correlation can be seen with the figure of favourable and unfavourable expressions for women by Hughes, quoted above, where the latter predominate. As can be seen in my graph of expressions for women, the number of the unfavourable ones is by far exceeding the rest. There is, however, another cause that might have been in effect. The Internet is a specific medium and one brief survey of online bulletin boards or the user comments at the main Czech news servers will reveal that people tend to be more offensive and use more vulgar words than it is probably usual for them when not hidden behind anonymity of a computer screen.

4. Political correctness and multiculturalism

It is difficult to say whether PC is solely an attempt to correct the reality through language as a means of social construction of reality or whether it has roots in attempts to make amends of the reality. Multiculturalism is such an attempt and politically correct language is one of the devices that are used to better the situation of the weaker groups or individuals. It is therefore necessary to mention the links between them.

According to Barša (2003) "multiculturalism should evoke positive utilization of dialogue and crossing of various cultural traditions." He also says that multiculturalism is a public policy approach for managing cultural diversity in a multiethnic society, officially stressing mutual respect and tolerance for cultural differences within a country. The word was first used in 1957 to describe Switzerland, but came into common currency in Canada in the late 1960s.

4.1 Origins in Canada

In Canada, multiculturalism was adopted in the 1970s. In the 1960s, the government set up a commission (Royal Commission on Bilingualism) to respond to the complaints of Canada's French-speaking minority concentrated in the Province of Quebec. The report of the Commission advocated that the Canadian government should recognize Canada as a bilingual and bicultural society and adopt policies to preserve this character. But there was the so-called "third force" – Canadians of origin different than English or French. Biculturalism did not accord with the interests of the western provinces, where the French population was low compared to other groups such as the Ukrainian Canadians. To accommodate these minority groups, the report was changed from *bilingualism and biculturalism* to *bilingualism and multiculturalism*. "So

multiculturalism was a compromise solution of the problem." (Barša 2003:46)

The Liberal Party government of Pierre Trudeau declared the *Announcement of Implementation of Policy of Multiculturalism within Bilingual Framework* in the House of Commons in 1971 (ibid:45) This was confirmed by adding section 27 of the Canadian Charter of Rights and Freedoms to the Canada's constitution from 1982. It says: "This Charter shall be interpreted in a manner consistent with the preservation and enhancement of the multicultural heritage of Canadians." (*Canada's 1982 constitution, section 27 of the Canadian Charter of Rights and Freedoms*)

These tendencies culminated in the Canadian *Multiculturalism Act* which was received in 1988. This act "obliges Canada to protect cultural and ethnical diversity of the Canadian society as a basic characteristic of the Canadian national identity." (Barša 2003:51) Projects aimed to preserve the ethnical identity started to be financed. This usually included folk dancing competitions and the construction of community centres.

The point I am aiming to is concerning language, PCL. Kymlicka (in Barša 2003) offers a list of thirteen official policies discussed in Canada in connection with multiculturalism. Among those such as affirmative actions and curricula revisions, he mentions "language codes banning use of racist, sexist and homophobic expressions at workplace and school." (Barša 2003:48) So a link between PC and multiculturalism may be traced

4.2 United States

Unlike in Canada, multiculturalism has never been adopted as an official policy on the federal level in the USA. Yet the situation has a degree of resemblance to certain extent; the famous American melting pot idea is in its own way concerned with including different groups of people into one nation. Officially, there has never been

any dominant culture, the nation was to be built again after the process of melting. This has never been accomplished, though.

The idea of melting pot was often criticized in the USA, as well as multiculturalism. D'Souza (1991) argues that the entrenchment of multiculturalism in American universities has undermined the universalistic values that liberal educations once attempted to foster. In particular, he was disturbed by the growth of ethnic studies programs, e.g. Black Studies.

Multiculturalism in the USA is attacked by some conservatives as an assault on the traditional Christian background of America and they point out the beginnings of the country as depicted by Jay (1787), the first American Supreme Court Chief Justice: "Providence has been pleased to give this one connected country to one united people — a people descended from the same ancestors, speaking the same language, professing the same religion, attached to the same principles of government, very similar in their manners and customs... This country and this people seem to have been made for each other, and it appears as if it was the design of Providence, that an inheritance so proper and convenient for a band of brethren, united to each other by the strongest ties, should never be split into a number of unsocial, jealous, and alien sovereignties."

However, multiculturalism is not only criticized in the USA. It is also praised as a beneficial outcome of the civil rights movement. One of the strong voices is Arthur M. Schlesinger, Jr., who used to be an advisor to the administrations of Kennedy, and who has won Pulitzer Prize two times, with his book titled *The Disuniting of America: Reflections on a Multicultural Society* (1998). According to Barša (2003), Schlesinger states that a new attitude - one that celebrates difference and abandons assimilation - may replace the classic image of the melting pot in which differences are submerged in democracy. He argues that ethnic awareness has had many positive consequences to unite a nation with a ‘history of

prejudice'; however, the 'cult of ethnicity', if pushed too far, may endanger the unity of society.

4.3 Political correctness as a result of multiculturalism

May it be stated that PC is an outcome of multiculturalism? It is not possible to be firm about this. It is more likely that PC is a phenomenon that bears resemblance with multiculturalism because the broader goals of both are similar, i.e. greater tolerance and equal opportunities for certain marginalized groups, or that PC is one of the means of introducing tolerance between those different groups of people.

III. PRACTICAL PART

1. On translation

Translation is doubtlessly a very complex and complicated process and the outcome depends on the translator's skill. The translator has to have a command of both source and target language, and also possess wide knowledge of cultural background and many particular branches of human activities. Since translation is such a complex activity, many theories of translation have been written.
Nowadays, the most recognised attitude is the functional approach:
"Dnes považujeme funkční přístup k překladu, funkční ekvivalenci za základní princip překladu." (Knittlová 1995:8)
"Nowadays we consider the functional approach to translation, the functional equivalence to be the essential principle of translation." (my translation)
In another publication by the same author, she contends:
"Ve všech nejnovějších anglosaských monografiích z oblasti teorie překladu se objevuje jednotná fronta, která se zaměřuje v první řadě na makropřístup, na kulturní zázemí, historické a lokální zasazení, literární narážky, reálie, vztah autora k tématu a k publiku, typ publika, typ textu a funkci textu, a teprve po tzv. strategickém rozhodnutí, které se zakládá na zařazení výchozího textu do uvedeného rámce, nastupuje fáze detailního rozhodování. Nastupuje mikropohled, který si všímá konkrétních jednotlivin, gramatických struktur a jejich lexikální náplně a dochází k budování definitivního cílového textu." (Knittlová, 2000: 21)
"In all latest Anglo-Saxon monographs on the theory of translation, a similar attitude can be traced. It foregrounds macro-attitude of cultural background, historical and local setting, allusions of literature, life and institutions, type and function of the text, and the part where particular decisions are made comes only after the so-called strategic decision of putting the text into this frame. Then

micro-attitude is employed, which deals with particular parts of language, grammar structures and lexical items, and the target text is created." (my translation)

In compliance with this approach, I have tried to translate, where possible, the stories so that they would offer reference to the Czech cultural background. Luckily, these stories can be found in Czech as well so there were no major troubles with it. Due to the different word order, I used transposition, substitution and other standard translation techniques. A few problems emerged with translation of the PC expressions. Some of them have not breached Czech in the form of loanwords or other yet, which signals that Czech is not so much inclined towards PC as English is. The most frequent problem was that I had to use amplification, which denotes using more words for one word in the source language or a longer expression for a shorter expression in the source language. The reason for doing so is lack of an equipollent expression in the target language so the expression has to be translated with help of a longer expression that offers sufficient information for the reader to grasp the meaning. The drawback of amplification is the length and clumsiness of the target expression. For the reason described above, this could not be completely avoided, however. I have managed to avoid use of calques at least.

2. Bedtime stories translation

2.1 The author's permission

Dear Mr. Hutsky:

Thank you for your nice email, and for your interest in my writing. I'm flattered that you chose my stories for your thesis, and as long as the translation isn't for a money-making enterprise, I gladly grant permission. If I can be of any help as you work on this, please let me know. Good luck!

Sincerely

Jim Garner

2.2 Red Riding Hood

Červená Karkulka

Byla jednou jedna mladá osoba[1] jménem Červená Karkulka, která žila se svou matkou na kraji velkého lesa. Jednoho dne ji matka požádala, zda by nedonesla košík s čerstvým ovocem a minerální vodou do domu své babičky – pochopitelně ne proto, že to byla ženská[2] práce, nýbrž z toho důvodu, že šlo o ušlechtilý skutek, který napomáhal vytvářet pocit vzájemné sounáležitosti[3]. Babička navíc *nebyla* nemocná, lépe řečeno těšila se dobrému fyzickému i duševnímu zdraví a byla plně způsobilá postarat se sama o sebe jako každý jiný dospělý jedinec[4].

A tak se Červená Karkulka se svým košíkem vydala na cestu lesem. Mnoho lidí les považovalo za zlověstné a nebezpečné místo a nikdy do něj nevkročilo. Červená Karkulka si však díky své právě pučící sexualitě byla natolik sebejistá, že se takovými očividně freudovskými představami nenechala zastrašit.

Cestou do domu své babičky byla Červená Karkulka zastavena a oslovena vlkem, který se jí dotázal, copak že to nese ve svém košíku. Odvětila: „Zdravou svačinu pro svoji babičku, která je bezpochyby schopná postarat se o sebe jako kterýkoliv jiný dospělý jedinec.“

Vlk řekl: „Víš drahoušku, že pro malou holčičku[5] není zrovna bezpečné, aby se tímto lesem procházela sama?“

Nato Červená Karkulka řekla: „Vaši sexistickou poznámku shledávám nanejvýš urážlivou, ale budu ji ignorovat kvůli Vašemu postavení vyvrhele společnosti a tlaku, který je na Vás v této pozici vyvíjen a který Vás nakonec donutil utvořit si svůj vlastní, zcela legitimní pohled na svět. Nyní, pokud mne omluvíte, se opět musím vydat na cestu.“

Červená Karkulka pokračovala dále po hlavní pěšině. Ale vlk, kterého status vyděděnce osvobodil od otrockého lpění na přímočarém stylu myšlení západní části světa, věděl o kratší cestě

do babiččina domu a tou se nyní vydal. Vřítil se do domu a snědl babičku, což byl ostatně pro masožravce jakým byl on zcela přirozený a ospravedlnitelný čin[6]. Poté, ani v nejmenším nezatížen zkostnatělými tradicionalistickými představami o tom, co se hodí pro muže a co pro ženu, si oblékl babiččinu noční košili a vlezl do postele.

Červená Karkulka vešla do domku a pravila: „Babičko, přinesla jsem ti nízkotučnou svačinu bez obsahu sodíku, abych se tak poklonila tvé roli moudré a pečující matriarchy[7].“

Z postele se tiše ozval vlk: „Pojď blíže, dítě, abych tě lépe viděla.“

Červená Karkulka řekla: „Ach, já zapomněla, že jsi nevidomá jako krtek[8]. Babičko, jaké to máš velké oči!“

„Hodně toho už viděly a hodně toho odpustily, má drahá.“

„Babičko, jaký to máš velký nos– tedy samozřejmě ze zcela subjektivního pohledu a rozhodně svým vlastním způsobem přitažlivý[9].“

„Hodně toho již cítil a hodně toho odpustil, má drahá.“

„Babičko, jaké to máš velké zuby!“

Vlk řekl: „Jsem šťastný s tím, *kdo* jsem a *čím* jsem,“ vyskočil z postele a chytil Červenou Karkulku do svých spárů s úmyslem pozřít ji. Červená Karkulka začala křičet, ne však kvůli vlkově evidentnímu sklonu převlékat se do ženských šatů, ale kvůli jeho záměrnému narušení jejího osobního prostoru.

Její křik zaslechl kolem procházející myslivec[10] (či osoba pověřená řízením lesních záležitostí, čemuž on sám dával přednost). Když vtrhl do domku a spatřil, co se zde odehrává, pokusil se zakročit. Jakmile však zvedl pušku, Červená Karkulka i vlk přestali.

„A co si jako myslíte, že děláte?“ zeptala se Červená Karkulka.

Osoba pověřená myslivostí zamrkala, zkusila cosi odpovědět, ale jaksi ji na to nenapadala vhodná odpověď.

„Vtrhnout sem jako neandrtálec s pocitem, že Vaše zbraň vše vyřeší za Vás!“ vykřikla Červená Karkulka. „Sexisto! Druhisto![11] Jak se vůbec opovažujete domnívat se, že ženy a vlci si nedokážou vyřešit své problémy bez pomoci muže!“

Jakmile uslyšela tuto plamennou řeč, vyskočila babička z vlkovy tlamy, sebrala osobě pověřené myslivostí pušku a ustřelila jí hlavu[12]. Po této tvrdé životní zkoušce Červená Karkulka, babička a vlk pocítili jistou shodu v pohledu na své životní poslání. Rozhodli se vytvořit alternativní domácnost založenou na vzájemné úctě a spolupráci[13] a žili spolu v lese šťastně až do své smrti.

2.2 The Emperor's New Clothes
Císařovy nové šaty

Daleko, předaleko, v čase již dávno zapomenutém, žil jeden potulný krejčí, který se dostal do cizí země. Krejčí, kteří cestují z místa na místo, si obyčejně hledí svého a dávají si pozor, aby nepřekročili hranice toho, co je v dané oblasti považováno za slušné. Tento krejčí však byl tuze společenský a měl oslabený smysl pro slušné chování[14], takže byl zanedlouho k vidění v místním lokále, kde v nepřiměřené míře požíval alkohol[15], narušoval osobní prostor zaměstnankyň podniku a vyprávěl neosvícené příhody o drátenících, sběračích chlévské mrvy a dalších živnostnících a živnostnicích[16].

Majitel podniku zavolal policii, která krejčího zatkla a předvedla před císaře. Jak jistě tušíte, na panovníkovi se podepsal dlouhý život strávený ve víře v absolutní opodstatněnost monarchie a v dědičnou nadřazenost příslušníků mužského pohlaví a učinil z něj ješitného a, co se moudrosti týče, poněkud omezeného[17] tyrana. Krejčí si těchto vlastností povšiml a rozhodl se využít je ve svůj prospěch.

Císař se zeptal, „Máš nějaké poslední přání, než tě navždy vyhostím ze svého panství?“

Krejčí odpověděl, „Pouze to, aby mi Vaše velebnost dovolila malou poctu – vytvořit pro ni nové královské šaty. Přivezl jsem si s sebou totiž speciální látku, která je tak vzácná a vybraná, že může být

viděna pouze určitými lidmi – typem lidí, které byste chtěl mít ve *Vaší* říši – lidmi, kteří jsou politicky korektní, morálně spravedliví, intelektuálně rafinovaní, kulturně tolerantní a kteří nekouří, nepijí, nesmějí se sexistickým vtipům, hodně se dívají na televizi a poslouchají country nebo grilují na zahradě.“[18]

Po krátké chvilce přemýšlení císař s tímto přáním souhlasil. Lichotila mu šovinistická a testosteronem obtěžkaná představa, že celá říše a její obyvatelé tu jsou pouze proto, aby on vypadal dobře. Bylo to jako vlastnit trofejní manželku a vynásobit ten pocit sto tisíci[19].

Žádná taková vzácná látka samozřejmě neexistovala. Léta života mimo hranice normální společnosti donutila[20] krejčího, aby si vytvořil svůj vlastní morální kodex, který ho nutil podvádět a přivést císaře do trapné situace ve jménu všech nezávislých živnostníků a živnostnic na celém světě. Takže zatímco pilně pracoval, podařilo se mu přesvědčit císaře o tom, že stříhá a šije kusy látky, která v nejstriktněji objektivním pojetí reality neexistovala.

Když krejčí oznámil, že je hotov, císař se rozhodl podívat se na sebe ve svém novém hávu v zrcadle. Jak tam tak stál, nahý jako v den, kdy přišel na svět, kdokoliv by si všimnul, jak léta vykořisťování rolnictva[21] změnila jeho tělo v ošklivou, beztvarou hmotu tvořenou opuchlým bílým masem[22]. Císař si toho pochopitelně povšiml též, nicméně předstíral, že se dívá na skvostný, politicky korektní šat. Aby se předvedl ve své nové vznešenosti, nařídil na druhý den slavnostní přehlídku.

Následujícího rána se jeho poddaní nahrnuli do ulic, aby shlédli průvod. Mezitím se roznesla zpráva, že císařovy nové šaty mohou vidět pouze ti lidé, kteří žijí zdravým životním stylem, a každý byl pevně rozhodnut být lepší než soused.

Přehlídka začala velkým humbukem. Jak se monarcha táhl po ulici se svým bledým, oteklým, patriarchálním tělem ne nepodobným mršině, každý dělal nahlas „Ó“ a „Á“, jakože vidí jeho nové, nádherné šaty[23]. Všichni až na jednoho malého chlapce, který vykřikl:

„Císař je nahý!“
Přehlídka se zastavila. Císař zaváhal. Na dav padlo ticho, až jeden pohotový rolník vykřikl:
„Ne, není. Císař prostě jenom propaguje alternativní oděvní životní styl!“
Z davu se ozvaly výkřiky radosti a zástupy lidí ze sebe začaly strhávat své oblečení a tancovat na sluníčku tak, jak je příroda stvořila. Od té doby přejali tento alternativní oděvní styl všichni v této zemi a krejčí, zbaven jakékoliv možnosti výdělku, si sbalil svou jehlu a nit a od té doby zde o něm nikdo neslyšel.

2.3 The Three Little Pigs

O třech prasátkách

Byla kdysi tři malá prasátka, která spolu žila ve vzájemném respektu a v harmonii se svým prostředím. Každé z nich si postavilo krásný domek z původních materiálů vlastních prostředí, v němž žila. Jedno si postavilo domek ze slámy, jedno z větví a jedno z mrvy, hlíny a vinné révy smíchaných do tvaru cihel následně vypálených v malé peci. Když skončila s prací, byla prasátka velmi spokojena a usadila se, aby strávila zbytek života v míru a sebeurčení.
Ale jejich idyla byla brzy otřesena. Jednoho dne se zde objevil velký zlý vlk s rozpínavými úmysly[24]. Uviděl prasátka a dostal velký hlad, jak v tělesném tak i ideologickém[25] slova smyslu. Když prasátka spatřila vlka, ukryla se v domku ze slámy. Vlk k němu přiběhl, zabušil na dveře a zvolal, „Prasátka, prasátka, pusťte mě dovnitř!“
Prasátka odpověděla, „Tvoje taktika vyjednávání z pozice síly[26] nemá žádnou šanci proti prasátkům bránícím svůj domov a kulturu.“

Ale vlk se nehodlal jen tak lehce vzdát toho, co považoval za své nevyhnutelné předurčení[27]. A tak se pořádně nadechl a sfoukl domek ze slámy. Vyděšená prasátka začala utíkat do domku z větví s vlkem těsně v patách. Pozemek, na němž stával domek ze slámy, koupili jiní vlci a založili zde banánovou plantáž.[28]

U domku z větví vlk opět zabušil na dveře a zvolal, „Prasátka, prasátka, pusťte mě dovnitř!“

Prasátka zvolala zpět, „Táhni k čertu, ty masožravý, imperialistický utiskovateli!“[29]

Vlk se tomu blahosklonně pousmál. Pomyslel si: „Svým způsobem jsou jako malé děti. Bude to škoda, až zmizí ze světa, ale pokrok se nedá zastavit.“[30]

A tak se pořádně nadechl a sfoukl domek z větví. Prasátka začala utíkat do domku z cihel s vlkem v těsném závěsu za nimi. Pozemek, na němž stával domek z větví, odkoupili jiní vlci a zbudovali na něm družstevní rekreační komplex pro vlky na dovolené, v němž byla každá chatka věrnou laminátovou kopií původního domku z větví, a mimo to zde vyrostly obchody s kuriozitami, byly poskytovány potápěčské kurzy a každý den předváděna představení se cvičenými delfíny.

U domku z cihel vlk opět zabušil na dveře a zvolal, „Prasátka, prasátka, pusťte mě dovnitř!“

Tentokrát prasátka odpověděla tím, že zapěla písně o solidaritě a napsala protestní dopis Spojeným národům.

Touto dobou již vlk začínal být na prasátka rozzloben, neboť odmítala podívat se na situaci i z pohledu masožravce. A tak se pořádně nadechl a začal foukat, pak se chytl za hruď a padl k zemi mrtev následkem infarktu způsobeného všemi těmi tučnými jídly, která za svůj život snědl.[31]

Tři malá prasátka měla velkou radost z toho, že spravedlnost zvítězila, a zahopsala krátký taneček kolem těla mrtvého vlka. Jejich dalším krokem bylo osvobodit svou domovinu. Svolala k sobě další prasátka z okolí, která byla vyhnána ze své země. Tato nová brigáda *vepřistů*[32] zaútočila s kulomety a raketomety na

rekreační komplex a zmasakrovala kruté vlčí utlačovatele, čímž vyslala jasný signál zbytku polokoule, aby se nemíchal do jejich vnitřních záležitostí. Poté prasátka zbudovala modelovou sociální demokracii s bezplatným vzděláním, všeobecnou zdravotní péčí a dostupným bydlením pro všechny.[33]

Upozornění: Vlk v této povídce byl metaforickou konstrukcí. Během psaní povídky nebyli zraněni žádní skuteční vlci.

2.4 Three Codependent Goats Gruff

Tři na sebe odkázáná kůzlátka Nerudovi

Na jednom překrásném horském úbočí žila tři kůzlátka, která vůči sobě byla v sourozeneckém vztahu. Jmenovala se Nerudovi a tvořila velmi těsně spjatou rodinu. Během zimních měsíců pobývala v svěžím zeleném údolí, pojídala trávu a dělala další věci, které neodmyslitelně patří k přirozenému kozímu způsobu života[34]. Když přišlo léto, obvykle se vydala nahoru směrem do hor, kde tou dobou rostla svěží tráva. Tak se jim dařilo nespást příliš mnoho trávy ve svém údolí a zanechat tak za sebou pokud možno co nejmenší ekologickou stopu[35].

Aby se dostala k těmto výše položeným pastvinám, musela kůzlátka přejít most přes širokou strž. Když se ohlásily první letní dny, jedno z nich se vydalo směrem k mostu. Toto kůzle bylo chronologicky nejméně pokročilé[36] a tím pádem dosáhlo nejmenšího kvantitativního výsledku v oblasti vzrůstu[37]. Když došlo k mostu, upevnilo si bezpečnostní helmu[38] a chytlo se zábradlí. Ale jakmile vykročilo na druhou stranu, zpod mostu se ozvalo hrozivé zavrčení.

Přes zábradlí se na most vyhoupl trol – chlupatý, více než průměrně pokrytý nečistotami[39] a produkující zvýšenou hladinu

zápachu[40]. „Aaaaargh," zaintonoval[41] trol. Jsem správce tohoto mostu a i přesto, že kozy mají právo přes něj přejít[42], sním každou, která se o to pokusí!"

„Ale proč, pane trole?" zamečelo kůzle.

„Protože jsem trol a jsem na to hrdý. Mám trolí potřeby a mezi ně patří pojídání koz, takže radši respektuj mé nároky nebo uvidíš."[43]

Kůzle se vyděsilo. „Samozřejmě, pane," zakoktalo. „Pokud Vám to, že mě sníte, pomůže stát se celistvým trolem, pak budu nadmíru potěšeno. Nemohu se však k tomuto postupu zavázat bez toho, aniž bych to konzultovalo se svými sourozenci. Omluvíte mne?" A odběhlo zpět do údolí.

Jako druhé se k mostu vydalo prostřední kůzle. To bylo chronologicky pokročilejší než kůzle první a tím pádem se těšilo výhodě větší velikosti (což z něj ovšem nečinilo lepší nebo zaslouženější kozu). Už se chystalo vkročit na most, když tu je zastavil trol.

„Příroda mě stvořila jako trola," řekl, „a já přijímám své trolství. Chceš mi odepřít mé právo na to prožít život trola tak plně a efektivně, jak jen mohu?"

„Já? Nikdy!" zvolalo kůzle hrdě.

„V tom případě zůstaň stát, než přejdu na druhou stranu a zhltnu tě. A nepokoušej se utéct, považoval bych to za osobní urážku." S těmito slovy se trol jal narušit osobního prostor kůzlete.

„Nicméně," vyhrklo spěšně kůzle, „mám rodinu, se kterou jsme si blízcí, a bylo by to ode mne sobecké nechat se sníst, aniž bych se jich předem zeptalo na jejich názor. Jejich pocity respektuji též. Velice nerado bych je svou absencí dostalo do emočně stresující situace tím, že..."

„Dobře, tak *běž*!" vykřikl trol.

„Jakmile dosáhneme názorové shody, poběžím neprodleně zpět," řeklo kůzle, „neboť by to bylo nečestné držet Vás v nejistotě."

„To je od tebe velice milé," povzdechl si trol a kůzle se rozběhlo zpět do údolí. Jak ale rostl jeho hlad, začínal mít trol čím dál větší

pocit křivdy. Pokud by se mu nepodařilo sníst ani jedno kůzle, byl pevně rozhodnut jít si stěžovat na místní správní úřad.

Když k mostu dorazilo třetí kůzle, zjistil trol, že tento již téměř dospělý jedinec je téměř dvakrát tak velký jako on sám a již disponuje velkými, ostrými rohy a tvrdými a těžkými kopyty. Rychle pochopil, že jeho výhoda založená na fyzickém zastrašování se rozplynula[44]. Zatímco strach měnil jeho vnitřnosti na rosol, padl trol na kolena a začal škemrat, „Prosím, prosím, odpusťte mi! Zneužíval jsem Vás[45] a Vaše sourozence pro své vlastní účely. Nevím, co mě k tomu vedlo, ale teď už vidím, jak moc jsem chyboval."

Kůzle také padlo na to, co dá u koz pokládat za kolena, a řeklo, „Ale no tak, nemůžete brát veškerou vinu na sebe. Do této situace Vás dostala naše přítomnost a náš extrémní stupeň poživatelnosti. Já a mí sourozenci se cítíme hrozně. Prosím, to *Vy* musíte odpustit *nám*."

Trol začal vzlykat. „Ne, ne, je to celé moje chyba. Vyhrožoval jsem vám a zastrašoval jsem vás, a to jen kvůli svému vlastnímu přežití. Jak sobecký jsem byl!"

Ale kůzle o tom nechtělo ani slyšet. „To my jsme byli sobci. Jediné, co nás napadlo, bylo zachránit si vlastní kůži a absolutně jsme opomněla Vaše potřeby. Prosím, snězte mě."

„Ne," řekl trol, „musíte mě za mou necitlivost a sobeckost shodit z toho mostu."

„Nic takového neudělám," řeklo kůzle, „protože v prvé řadě jsme to byla my, kdo Vám dělal chutě. Tady, kousněte si. Pusťte se do toho."

„Já Vám říkám, že jestli je tu někdo vinen," řekl trol, obhajujíc svůj postoj, „pak jsem to já. Nyní mě prosím rychle shoďte z tohoto mostu."

„Podívejte," řeklo kůzle a zdvihlo se do plné výšky, „nikdo mi nebude brát mou vinu za tuhle situaci, ani Vy ne, takže mě snězte než vás praštím do nosu."

„Nehraj tu na mě hru na to, kdo je víc vinen, ty rohatko!"

„Rohatko? Ty smrdutá koule chlupů[46]! Já ti ukážu, na čí hlavu padá víc viny!“ A s těmito slovy se do sebe pustili a kousali, bouchali a kopali do se ve snaze vzít na sebe co největší podíl viny.
Ostatní dvě kůzlata se přiřítila k mostu a uzřela pranici. S pocitem, že na sebe nevzala dostatečné množství viny, se vnořila do klubka chlupů, kopyt, rohů a zubů. Ale malý most nebyl na takovou váhu stavěn. Zatřásl se, zakymácel a nakonec se prolomil a trol i tři na sobě závislá kůzlátka se propadli do propasti. Cestou dolů každý z nich pocítil velkou úlevu, protože se jim konečně dostane toho, co si zaslouží, a navíc jako bonus ještě trochu viny navíc za osud ostatních.

2.5 Cinderella

Popelka

Žila jednou jedna mladá dívka jménem Popelka, jejíž biologická matka zemřela, když byla Popelka ještě malé dítě. Několik let nato se její otec znovu oženil s vdovou, která měla dvě dcery. Macecha se k Popelce chovala velice krutě a její nevlastní sestry ji nutily tvrdě pracovat, jako by byla jejich osobní neplacenou pomocnicí[47].
Jednoho dne do jejich domu dorazila pozvánka. Princ se rozhodl oslavit své úspěšné vykořisťování na kraj společnosti odsunutých a vlastnictví zbavených rolníků tím, že uspořádá noblesní bál. Popelčiny sestry byly z pozvání do paláce u vytržení. Začaly dumat nad nákladnými šaty, které by mohly použít k pozměnění a zotročení přirozené podoby svého těla tak, aby se vyrovnaly nereálnému standardu ženské krásy[48] (v jejich případě to bylo obzvlášť nereálné, neboť obě byly po vzhledové stránce hendikepované jako noc[49].) Macecha na ples plánovala jít také, takže Popelka musela dřít jako kůň (ne zrovna vhodná, nicméně trefná to druhistická[50] metafora), aby bylo vše připraveno.

Když konečně nastal den bálu, Popelka pomohla svým sestrám a maceše obléci se do svých plesových šatů. Byl to skličující úkol, ne zcela nepodobný tomu snažit se nacpat deset kilo zpracovaných zvířecích mršin do kůže, do níž se vleze kilo maximálně pět. Poté přišlo na řadu nesmírné kosmetické rozšíření[51], o kterém by možná bylo lepší se vůbec nezmiňovat. Jakmile se snesl večer, macecha a nevlastní sestry odjely a zanechaly Popelku doma, aby dokončila své domácí práce. Popelka byla smutná, ale spokojila se s poslechem skladeb od své oblíbené aktivistky za ženská práva Holly Near.[52]

Najednou se před Popelkou v záblesku světla zjevil muž ve volných šatech ze stoprocentní bavlny a klobouku se širokým lemem. Popelka se nejprve domnívala, že jde o jižanského právníka nebo hráče z nějaké kapely, ale brzy byla vyvedena z omylu.

„Ahoj Popelko, jsem tvoje kouzelná osoba, jež zastupuje dítě při křtu[53], nebo – chceš-li – tvůj osobní prostředník pro styk s božstvem. Takže ty bys chtěla jít na bál? A nechat se spoutat mužským pojetím krásy?[54] Nacpat se do těsných šatů, které ti přiškrtí krevní oběh? Vmáčknout své nohy do střevíců na vysokém podpatku, které naruší strukturu tvých kostí? Pomalovat svou tvář chemikáliemi a líčidly, které byly testovány na jiných než lidských tvorech.“[55]

„Ó ano, rozhodně,“ řekla Popelka bez zaváhání. Její kouzelný osobní prostředník pro styk s božstvem[56] si ztěžka povzdechl a rozhodl se odložit její dovzdělání v oblasti politické korektnosti na někdy jindy. Popelku obklopilo krásné, jasné světlo a za pomoci čárů byla odnesena do zámku.

Mnoho a mnoho kočárů stálo tu noc před palácem. Očividně zde do té doby nikoho nenapadlo vymyslet princip spolujízdy[57]. Zanedlouho sem dorazila Popelka v těžkém, zlatem zdobeném kočáře s námahou taženém skupinou kopytnatých otroků[58]. Oblečena byla v přiléhavých šatech utkaných z hedvábí ukradeného nic netušícím červíkům. Ve vlasech se jí třpytily perly vydrancované z mušlí tvrdě pracujících, bezbranných ústřic[59]. A ač

se to může zdát nebezpečné, na nohou měla pantofle z umně zpracovaného křišťálu.

Když Popelka vstoupila do sálu, obrátily se k ní všechny pohledy. Muži přímo toužebně zírali na tuto ženu, která přesně vystihla jejich představy o ženské dokonalosti á la panenka Barbie. Ženy, již od útlého věku cvičené k tomu, aby opovrhovaly svými těly, se na Popelku dívaly se závistí a nevraživostí. Popelčina macecha a nevlastní sestry byly v tu chvíli dokonce natolik stravovány žárlivostí, že se jim ji ani nepodařilo poznat.

Popelka na sebe během krátké chvíle přitáhla i pohled prince, který právě se svými starými známými diskutoval o turnajích a štvaní psů na uvázaného medvěda a mezitím nenápadně pošilhával po děvčatech. Jakmile ji spatřil, byl zasažen záchvatem neschopnosti mluvit, stejně jako většina populace. „Zde," pomyslel si, „je žena, kterou bych mohl učinit svou princeznou a spojením našich dokonalých genů s ní vytvořit další generaci[60] a stát se tak objektem závisti pro všechny prince na míle daleko. A navíc je to blondýna!"

Princ se vydal přes sál směrem ke své vyhlédnuté kořisti. Jeho přátelé taktéž vykročili směrem k Popelce a stejně tak i všichni další muži v sále[61], kterým bylo pod sedmdesát nebo nemuseli obsluhovat u stolů.

Popelka byla na rozruch, který způsobila, pyšná. Kráčela s hlavou vzpřímenou a nesla se jako žena význačného sociálního postavení. Ale brzy bylo zřejmé, že tento neklid se začíná měnit v něco ošklivého či přinejmenším sociálně dysfunkčního[62].

Princ dal svým přátelům jasně najevo, že je pevně rozhodnutý tuto ženu „vlastnit". Jeho odhodlanost je však pouze popudila, neboť i oni po ní nesmírně zatoužili a chtěli ji proměnit ve svůj majetek. Muži začali vykřikovat a strkat se. Princův nejlepší přítel – velký byť intelektuálně poněkud omezený vévoda – ho zastavil v půli cesty přes taneční parket a začal naléhat, že to musí být *on*, kdo bude mít Popelku. Princ mu kvapně odpověděl kopancem do rozkroku, čehož následkem zůstal vévoda ve stavu dočasné

nečinnosti[63]. Během krátké chvilky byl však princ pohlcen v klubku dalších lidských zvířat poblázněných myšlenkou na sex.

Ženy byly tímto brutálním projevem testosteronu[64] zděšeny, ale ačkoliv se snažily co jim síly stačily, rváče se jim od sebe oddělit nepodařilo. Ženy, které zrovna nebyly zaměstnány uklidňováním situace, se upomenuly, že zdrojem všech těchto potíží byla Popelka, a tak ji obklopily a začaly jí dávat najevo svou velice nesesterskou zášť. Popelka se snažila uniknout, ale její nepraktické křišťálové pantofle to téměř znemožňovaly. Naštěstí pro ni nebyly ostatní ženy obuty o nic lépe.

Hluk vřavy už byl v tuto chvíli natolik silný, že si nikdo ani nevšiml zvuku zvonů, které začaly odbíjet půlnoc. Ve chvíli, kdy odezněl dvanáctý úder, Popelčiny nádherné šaty a pantofle zmizely a místo nich tu stála oblečena vy svém starém, otrhaném oděvu. Její macecha a nevlastní sestry raději zůstaly mlčet, aby se vyhnuly nepříjemnostem.

Po této magické proměně ženy úplně ztichly. Mezitím si Popelka, osvobozená od pevného sevření svých šatů, oddechla, protáhla se a poškrábala si pohmožděná žebra. Usmála se, zavřela oči a řekla, „Klidně mě sestry zabijte, ale aspoň zemřu v pohodlí.“

Ženy kolem ní začaly opět žárlit, ale tentokrát zvolily zcela jiný přístup. Místo toho, aby se Popelce pomstily, začaly ze sebe strhávat korzety, živůtky, střevíce a další části ošacení, které je omezovaly v pohybu. A v záchvatu upřímné radosti začaly tancovat, skákat a pištět, konečně se ve svém oblečení cítíc pohodlně.

Kdyby muži bývali vzhlédli od svého destruktivního macho tance, uzřeli by mnoho přitažlivých žen oblečených jakoby se právě chystaly ulehnout na lože. Ale ke své škodě nikdy nepřestali a sekali, bušili, kopali a tloukli do sebe tak dlouho, až byli všichni do jednoho mrtvi.

Ženy mezi sebou vzniklou situaci rozebraly, ale lítost necítily žádnou. Palác a celá říše, to vše nyní náleželo jim. První věcí, kterou udělaly, bylo to, že převlékly muže do šatů, jež samy

odhodily, a pak vydaly oficiální zprávu pro tisk, ve které prohlásily, že bitka se strhla kvůli tomu, že někdo začal vyhrožovat veřejným odhalením sklonů prince a jeho druhů k převlékání se do ženských šatů. Druhým krokem bylo založení družstevního podniku na výrobu pohodlného, praktického oblečení pro ženy. Poté na zámek umístily billboard s reklamou na PopelWear (tak bylo nové oblečení pojmenováno) a skrz svobodné rozhodování a chytrou marketingovou strategii pak všechny – dokonce i macecha a její dcery – žily šťastně až do smrti.

2.6 Comments on Little Red Riding Hood

The original story is about a fight between the good and the evil, the former represented by the characters of Red Riding Hood, grandmother and the woodchopper, and the latter by the wolf, which is a symbol of evil lurking in the forest, a symbol deeply rooted in the Euro-American culture. In the politically correct version, the roles are modified.

Red Riding Hood keeps the role of a good character; this position is not based on the powerlessness and naivety of a child, however. The other way round, she is very mature, class-conscious and aware of the issues of the equality between women and men, as well as of issues of PC. These attributes embodied in a little girl have a comical effect.

The wolf represents evil for the great part of the story. It is not his wolfish manners what is considered bad, however. It is rather his insensitivity and impoliteness. Nevertheless, in the surprising ending he joins the ranks of the good characters, as opposed to the woodchopper, who takes over the role of the evil one. In my opinion, the ending of the story may be interpreted as follows: Red Riding Hood represents women and the wolf represents an ethnic minority. The woodchopper stands for a WASP male and he thinks it to be absolutely normal to intervene in the dealings of the other two characters. His eventual elimination symbolizes emancipation and this is the moral, or the 'good ending', of the story. This ending substitutes for the 'good ending' of the original story, i.e. the death of the wolf as the evil character.

[1] In the original text, *young person* was used. This is obviously a replacement for *girl*. Standing alone, *young person* does not carry a big amount of political correctness. Using such an expression to avoid a word marking sex of the person in a fairy tale seems

somewhat out of place, however. There was no problem with translation and the Czech expression seems similarly out of place in this particular context as the English one.

[2] Neologism *womyn* was used in the original text. I have dealt with it in the theoretical part of my work.

[3] This additional piece of information is trying not to suggest that a certain type of task is associated with the role of a woman.

[4] What can be seen here is an attempt to evade eliciting a feeling that the grandmother is less capable of taking care of herself just because of her age and that because of her age she is no less valuable a person than anyone else. Beyond, if this attempt had not been made, such a thought probably would not come to one's mind or at least this thought would not be arrived to on the conscious level. This similarly superfluous remark is used one more time in the following paragraph.

[5] The wolf is the 'evil' character of the story. It seems, however, that not simply because he wants to eat other characters, as it is the case in the original Red Riding Hood story, but because he behaves the least politically correct of all the other characters, possibly with the exception of the woodchopper, who has only a small role in this story, however.

[6] The action that was probably the most despicable in the original tale, i.e. eating the grandmother, is now marginalized and even pardoned because it would be politically incorrect to condemn this action as the wolf behaved in what may be called 'natural wolfish manner'.

[7] After some consideration, I used *matriarcha* instead of *starší žena jako hlava rodu* because the former is more formal and therefore stands out more of the bedtime stories style.

[8] *optically challenged* is a politically correct euphemism of *blind*. I have translated it as *nevidomá*, which is the word used for people with this type of handicap in the Czech media. C.f.: according to *The Czech National Corpus*, the word *nevidomý* has 71 hits

meanwhile *slepec* 127. This indicates that although *slepec* is used more often, *nevidomý* has become a widely accepted standard, too.

[9] Bewildered Red Riding Hood made a slip of the tongue and quickly amended her previous remark that could have been interpreted as being offensive by the recipient.

[10] There is a woodchopper in the English version of the story. In the Czech one, *myslivec* takes his role. It is a profession that is generally acknowledged to be an exclusively male profession, probably because of the male-hunter stereotype image. I could see no way to translate *woodchopper-person* used by the author so I kept the unaltered Czech word *myslivec* and translated the politically correct synonym in the brackets. It is a gender-neutral term and sounds more politically correct, if not very naturally to a Czech native speaker, who probably would not use this expression, not even in a very formal conversation.

[11] *Speciesist*, the word used in the English version of the story, does not exist in English. *A racist* is someone who has a prejudiced attitude towards different races; *a male chauvinist* is someone who has a prejudiced attitude towards women. Similarly, *a speciesist* is someone who has a prejudiced attitude towards different species. Since interaction between humans and animals is not usually considered to be a fight for power, as it is the case of human interaction, there was no need for such a word to come to existence. Correspondingly, there is no word for this kind of person in Czech and I had to invent one that would be conveying the meaning and would also have a form similar to the Czech counterparts of *racist, male chauvinist*, etc. so that the meaning would be comprehensible.

[12] This is actually a second degree murder. Instead of valuing it negatively, the narrator generates a feeling of a justified retribution; just as the death of the wolf in the original story is viewed as an absolutely legitimate act.

[13] This is a PC ending. They not only lived happily ever after, they also managed to establish a form of a social group, where privileges and power were shared equally.

2.7 Comments on The Emperor's New Clothes

Unlike in the original story, a classic work by Hans Christian Andersen, the emperor is submitted to critique not only because of his pride and vanity, but because of his male chauvinism, too. The tailor is not depicted as a swindler, which is the case of the original story; responsibility for swindling is taken away from him and instead the blame goes to the years of living outside the bounds of normal society that oblige him to swindle. The ending is altered, too. The story does not end with the emperor's humiliation and him continuing to pretend to see the clothes. In the PC version by Garner, the emperor's dignity is saved by the serfs adopting nudity as a standard of clothing. So it is eventually the opinion of people what decides which points of view are accepted and which are not.

[14] In other words, the tailor was *rude*.

[15] *Alcohol abuse* is an established expression in English, as well as *drug abuse*. Surprisingly, the Czech language does not put alcohol and drugs on the same level as English does. We say *zneužívat drogy* but the expression *zneužívat alkohol* is not so common. I have not found even one concord of this collocation of *zneužívat* in *The Czech National Corpus*. One of the few areas where it can be found is law language. The Czech penal code states: "Kdo svádí jiného ke zneužívání jiné návykové látky než alkoholu nebo ho v tom podporuje anebo kdo zneužívání takové látky jinak podněcuje nebo šíří, bude potrestán odnětím svobody až na tři léta nebo zákazem činnosti nebo peněžitým trestem." (140/1961 Sb., trestní zákon, §188a) But the language of law is a specific area of

language and the collocation would sound somewhat out of place in an everyday conversation. Beyond, even in this example, *alcohol* is not an explicit object of the verb *zneužívat*, it is rather roofed by *addictive drugs* (*návykové látky*). This collocation of *zneužívat* is definitely less established than *zneužívat moc* (*abuse power*), for instance. Is this indicative of the Czechs' attitude towards alcohol? Because of this disproportion between Czech and English vocabulary, I chose *nepřiměřeně požívat alkohol* since it both sounds naturally in Czech and suggests that it is not right to abuse alcohol.

[16] *Tradespeople* is a replacement for *tradesmen*. I was not able to come up with a Czech genderless counterpart (all these are gender marked: *živnostník, obchodník, řemeslník*) so I have decided to use two expressions instead to emulate gender impartiality.

[17] I am fully aware that this may be too long a translation of an English compound adjective (*wisdom-challenged*). But I believe that it keeps to the original meaning as much as possible. If I used *intelektuálně omezený* or *rozumově omezený*, I would have saved some space but I would also have changed the meaning of the word *wisdom*. Also *poněkud* cannot be omitted as it is actually what makes the expression sound politically correct, or less offensive at least. Mere *omezený* may be interpreted as being offensive in Czech.

[18] The author suggests that all those listed positive features may go with people who watch television too much, or who listen to country music or barbecue, which might hint at white people form the middle class.

[19] A remark making fun of men who consider a woman their property.

[20] This is avoidance of responsibility for lying and cheating from the tailor to the unfavourable surroundings, which may be a negative byproduct of PCL.

[21] *Rolnictvo* sounds more like a term from a history lesson so I preferred it to *sedláci*.

[22] As in the Cinderella story, there is quite a disgusting reference to flesh in connection with human body. It could have been employed in order to produce an effect of sudden contrast with inoffensive PCL.

[23] *Hoopla*, used in the English version, might suggest that PC is hoopla, too. Many people use PCL in public but not in private informal conversations. They accept PCL where it is necessary or required, e.g. at a workplace shared with members of minorities, but they needn't be so polite when not required to be. In such a case when politeness is not interiorised and PCL is not an instrument of genuine respect of an individual to another individual or group, PCL is only an empty shell.

2.7 Comments on The Three Little Pigs

According to Hintjens (2005), this story bears resemblance to the situation in Cuba. Since this resemblance could be traced in the text, I asked the author of the book whether it really had been his intention that the story would evoke such an impression or whether it is just a coincidence.

James Finn Garner kindly offered an answer:

"Yes, I fully intended to evoke images of US intervention in Latin America, although I wasn't specific about where (we've done it so many times that I suppose you could take your pick of which country). I thought I drove the point home by calling the pigs 'porcinistas', which is so similar to 'Sandinistas' from Nicaragua."

If the pigs were to represent Cuba, and the wolf the USA, what is this view be grounded on? There are several places that support this point of view and I will mention them later.

The original story for children ends with the death of the wolf and the moral is that things should be done thoroughly if one wants to succeed in this world. As in the other stories, the plot roughly follows the original plot and the ending is altered. The wolf does not die in a cauldron of boiling water but his health fails him in the end.

[24] It is not a usual collocation of a wolf and *expansionist ideas*. This expression probably hints at the USA policy in the Western hemisphere after the World War II.

[25] The wolf (the USA) was not interested only in pork meat (the land of the country), but this struggle is also a struggle of different ideologies.

[26] *Gunboat tactics* (or *gunboat diplomacy*) is diplomacy backed by the threat of force.

[27] The foreign policy of the USA is sometimes criticized for viewing its role in the world too subjectively and not being able to take other views and cultures into account.

[28] The Americans owned a lot of Cuba land when Batista was in power. It probably would not be too bold to take a guess and say that if Castro hadn't come to power, Cuba would be full of seaside resorts where many Americans would spend vacation.

[29] If the word *carnivorous* was left out, the sentence "Go to hell, you carnivorous, imperialistic oppressor!" could be a part of an anti-American propaganda speech.

[30] This is a hint at smugness of Americans.

[31] May this be a hint at the Bay of Pigs invasion?

[32] *Porcinistas*, as the author of the book revealed, was coined on the basis of similarity to *Sandinistas*, members of a Nicaraguan political party founded on broad socialist principles.

[33] This is a hint at the social principles of many socialistic-oriented countries in Latin America.

Comments on The Three Codependent Goats Gruff

This story is about a conflict of interests between the troll, who needs to eat in order to survive, and the goats, who don't want to be eaten in order to survive – a normal relationship between a predator and its prey. Through applying PC on this natural relationship, the story becomes very ridiculous in the end.

In the beginning, the troll has an advantage in size and he wants to eat the coming goats, using PC as a means of reaching his goal with the minimum of effort. The goats, on the other hand, camouflage their fear of being eaten with help of PC. In other words, neither side reveals its true motivation and use PC to cloak their real intentions. It is not my aim to suggest that this is always the case with PC. It may, however, be used as an unfair means of covering one's true goals. Applying PC on something as simple and natural as the struggle between a predator and prey brings a very comical outcome.

Later on in the story, when he loses his advantage in size, the troll uses PC again, this time he has a different motivation, however. Not even now is his PC based on his genuine respect of the other side; his admitting a fault is rather an attempt to wriggle out of a possible threat of a confrontation he is afraid of. Nevertheless, the eldest of the three goats continues with urging the troll to admit that the situation they find themselves in is a fault of the goats, exactly the thing the troll is denying. Eventually, when they both already see red because of the stubbornness of the other one, they throw away their PC cloak and reveal the real face of their anger. In the ridiculous ending, they all die with a feeling of satisfaction at the fact that they did not betray the principles of PC, as if these values were worth scarifying one's life to them.

[34] *Goatish manner* is elevated to a cultural value equivalent to those of the minorities that have gained certain degree of general recognition.

[35] Ecological footprint is a unit of measurement used to express what is the size of the area of soil one person needs to cover their needs for food, clothing, energy, etc.

[36] The goat was the youngest of the siblings.

[37] The goat was the smallest of the siblings.

[38] A safety helmet is not an object one could usually find in a fairy tale.

[39] The troll was dirty.

[40] The troll smelled.

[41] *To intone* is not a word that would be normally used here. It would be more suitable to use *to roar*, for example. It was probably used to keep the image of the troll as a being that would not commit himself to such an impolite action as to yell at or intimidate someone, and in contrast with *Aaaaargh*, which does not collocate with *to intone*, synonyms of which are *to sing (a song)* or *to hum (a tune)*.

[42] The troll, unlike the trolls from regular fairy tales, is not a non-thinking, bad creature and, leaving his motivations aside, he is at least aware of existence of the rights of others.

[43] *You better respect my rights or else*. This attitude of forced respect to someone else's needs is a criticized feature of PC.

[44] In spite of his political correctness, the troll was fully aware of his advantage.

[45] Use of the polite form is a characteristic of some languages which is connected to the status of the participants of a conversation. I employed it as a means of expressing the subordination the goats felt at first, and the troll's change from using informal addressing to formal addressing demonstrates the change of his perception of his power status.

[46] They are becoming really upset now. They forget about their PC and are calling each other names.

Comments on Cinderella

As it was the case with Red Riding Hood and The Emperor's New Clothes, the Cinderella story more or less keeps the frame of the original story for children with the exception of a different, surprising ending.

This story is mainly concerned with the situation of women, who are exposed to the pressure of the fashion industry and society in general. It is quite natural that every person, woman or man, wants to look good in order to be attractive for a potential or the present partner, to feel good, or for both reasons at the same time. Nonetheless, if a man has a strong aesthetic sense and spends a lot of time and money on his appearance and lifestyle, he is called *a metrosexual*. This term has become accepted and it is not considered a downright deviation; yet it evokes an impression of something that is different from the usual notion of masculinity. The above mentioned behaviour is more or less expected of a woman, however. So far, there is nothing wrong about these different notions of masculinity and femininity; even most women consider themselves to be the more aesthetic and beautiful of the two sexes after all. The problem is when the pressure on a woman to be attractive becomes too strong and an unrealistic image of beauty is created in order to make women feel unhappy with themselves and therefore be a sitting target for commercials on products that should allegedly help them reach the unrealistic objective, e.g. cosmetics, cosmetic surgery, diet products, etc.

The character of Cinderella in this story wants to be attractive and take part in a 'social dance' of the ball. To reach this objective, she gladly takes an offered chance in spite of the fact that she is warned by her godperson of all the uncomfortable conditions she would have to suffer.

The frame of the original story is completely abandoned after Cinderella arrives at the ball. The two main issues of the ending of

the story are the inability of the men to control their libido and tendency to aggression, and the women's emancipation from the masculine dictation of feminine beauty. In my opinion, the right of women to choose their own standard of beauty, or at least to have a choice to accept or not to accept the current one without penalty, is the moral of the politically correct version of the story.

[47] This stands for *maid*.

[48] Some feminists point out to the fact that women are forced to alter their natural body images because of the pressure the society put on their appearance, particularly the pressure brought by the topical standards of women beauty dictated by the fashion industry, which are often very different from what may be considered normal, and in some cases even healthy.

[49] The original utterance was *they were differently visaged enough to stop a clock*, which is an alteration of *ugly enough to stop a clock* idiom. I have similarly altered *škaredá jako noc*. I did not translate the word *differently* literally, however. I thought that *po vizuální stránce odlišné jako noc* would not be indicative enough of the parallel with the phrase *škaredá jako noc* for a Czech reader, in spite of the fact that *visually handicapped* probably would not be politically correct enough in English.

[50] This word, which does not exist in Czech, was used in the Red Riding Hood story already.

[51] It is not specifically stated what is being augmented; the word *cosmetic* implies, however, that this augmentation concerns the woman's ability to catch attention of the opposite sex with help of certain physical features that are generally known and deliberately highlighted.

[52] Holly Near is a famous American singer, actor and activist. She is not only an activist for the rights of women, she also rails against war and all kinds of inequity.

[53] Even though it is much longer, I have translated non-existing word *godperson* as osoba, která zastupuje dítě při křtu so that the expression keeps its genderlessness.

[54] The godperson gives a list of the things some feminists criticize as a result of the dictate of patriarchal society, which often judges women on the basis of their physical appearance instead on their personality and skills.

[55] This means *animals*.

[56] I have decided to stick to *prostředník* to preserve usage of male gender here.

[57] Carpooling is shared use of a car, in particular for commuting to work, often by people who each have a car but travel together to save costs. I was long wondering whether I should keep the original word or use *spolujízda*, which is a Czech translation that has appeared only recently, but has probably become accepted by now. One occurrence of it could be found in *The Czech National Corpus*. I have eventually decided to include the word *princip* as it helps the reader who has never heard of carpooling grasp the meaning.

[58] Horses.

[59] Words as *to steal* or *to plunder* suggest that it is not right to exploit the natural resources.

[60] It was quite difficult to find a Czech counterpart to the word 'impregnate', which is even more formal than the most formal Czech words 'oplodnit' and 'obtěžkat'. I have therefore chosen this phrase, which sounds formal enough and also preserves alliteration of sounds in the original 'progeny' and 'genes'.

[61] Was there no gay among the men present at the ballroom?

[62] *Socially dysfunctional* is probably replacing *wild* here.

[63] *To be left temporarily inactive* stands for *to faint* here.

[64] *Vicious display of testosterone* substitutes *fight*.

IV. Conclusion

Having considered all available information discussed in the theoretical part, my final interpretation of the relationship between PC and power is that PC is a *strange language planning* (a term made up by me). It bears characteristic features of *language planning*; it does not come from the established official authorities, who have power, however. It is rather an attempt to make those authorities accept a new perception of reality defined by certain groups who (no doubt justly) gained some amount of public recognition and power in the second half of the twentieth century (e.g. ethnic minorities, women, gays, etc), and to persuade the authorities to promote this perception of reality through official language planning as a new valued standard. The old valued standard may have dwindled but so far has not been replaced by the new one. This is illustrated by my translation of *The Politically Correct Bedtime Stories* that will probably amuse most of the readers at least in some passages, which is a result of not having accepted this language (and social reality built up through it) as absolutely valid, valued and unquestionable language standard.

The goal of the practical part of the thesis was to show that the Czech language offers an equally wide range of politically correct expressions as the English language does in spite of the fact that the Czech society is not so inclined towards using politically correct language as some English speaking countries are. The practical part showed that there was no lack of Czech counterparts of the politically correct English expressions. Some had to be coined; in many of such cases, however, the English expressions were coined for the purpose of the particular story and do not exist in English as well.

Supposing the Czech society is not so concerned with politically correct language, it was another goal to put to the test whether the same or similar comical effect as *Politically Correct Bedtime*

Stories have could be achieved in Czech. This requires several preconditions the reader of the Czech translation must meet. First, he or she must be aware of existence of the phenomenon of political correctness and what it strives for, e.g. be aware of existence of gender studies. Next, he or she must have encountered at least some of the politically correct terms in a serious context, e.g. the use of *Romany* instead of *gipsy* in the Czech media. And the last but not the least, the reader must understand that these politically correct expression are deliberately set in a context that is not natural for them and thus creates a contrast, which builds a satirical effect.

If these conditions are met, I believe that the reader may find the stories amusing. To what extend, in comparison with the English original, is up to individual consideration.

V. Resume

The objective of this diploma thesis is to focus on politically correct language and on the merits it may bring to society as well as on the criticized negative aspects of it. A necessary part of this was to search for the links between power, power relationships and language, and for inequity reflected in language. The practical part is concerned with translation of five satirical stories from *Politically Correct Bedtime Stories* by J. F. Garner. It was my goal to show that Czech is fully capable of providing as many politically correct expressions as English in spite of the fact that the Czech society is not as inclined to political correctness as some English-speaking countries are.

Cílem diplomové práce je zaměřit se na politicky korektní jazyk, na význam, který může přinést společnosti, stejně tak jako na kritizované negativní aspekty. Součástí toho bylo zkoumání souvislostí mezi mocí, vztahy, v nichž je moc realizována, a jazyka a dále nespravedlností patrnou v jazyce. Praktická část se zabývá překladem pěti satirických pohádek z knihy *Politicky korektní pohádky na dobrou noc (Politically Correct Bedtime Stories)* od J. F. Garnera. Mým cílem bylo ukázat, že čeština je stejně schopná vyjádřit politicky korektní výrazy jako jazyk anglický i přesto, že v české společnosti není politická korektnost natolik zakořeněná jako v některých anglicky mluvících zemích.

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VII. Appendix

Politically Correct Bedtime Stories in English

LITTLE RED RIDING HOOD

There once was a young person named Red Riding Hood who lived with her mother on the edge of a large wood. One day her mother asked her to take a basket of fresh fruit and mineral water to her grandmother's house – not because this was womyn's work, mind you, but because the deed was generous and helped engender a feeling of community. Furthermore, her grandmother was *not* sick, but rather was in full physical and mental health and was fully capable of taking care of herself as a mature adult.

So Red Riding Hood set off with her basket through the woods. Many people believed that the forest was a foreboding and dangerous place and never set foot in it. Red Riding Hood, however, was confident enough in her own budding sexuality that such obvious Freudian imagery did not intimidate her.

On the way to Grandma's house, Red Riding Hood was accosted by a wolf, who asked her what was in her basket. She replied, "Some healthful snacks for my grandmother, who is certainly capable of taking care of herself as a mature adult."

The wolf said, "You know what, my dear, it isn't safe for a little girl to walk through these woods alone."

Red Riding Hood said, "I find your sexist remark offensive in the extreme, but I will ignore it because of your traditional status as an outcast from society, the stress of which has caused you to develop your own, entirely valid, worldview. Now, if you'll excuse me, I must be on my way."

Red Riding Hood walked on along the main path. But, because his status outside society had freed him from slavish adherence to linear, Western-style thought, the wolf knew a quicker route to Grandma's house. He burst into the house and ate Grandma, an entirely valid course of action for a carnivore such as himself. Then, unhampered by rigid, traditionalist notions of what was masculine or feminine, he put on Grandma's nightclothes and crawled into bed.

Red Riding Hood entered the cottage and said, “Grandma, I have brought you some fat-free, sodium-free snacks to salute you in your role of a wise and nurturing matriarch.”

From the bed, the wolf said softly. “Come closer, child, so that I might see you.”

Red Riding Hood said, “Oh, I forgot you are as optically challenged as a bat. Grandma, what big eyes you have!”

“They have seen much, and forgiven much, my dear.”

“Grandma, what a big nose you have – only relatively, of course, and certainly attractive in its own way.”

It has smelled much, and forgiven much, my dear.”

“Grandma, what big teeth you have!”

The wolf said, “I am happy with *who* I am and *what* I am,” and leaped out of bed. He grabbed Red Riding Hood in his claws, intent on devouring her. Red Riding Hood screamed, not out of alarm at the wolf’s apparent tendency towards cross-dressing, but because of his willful invasion of her personal space.

Her screams were heard by a passing woodchopper-person (or log-fuel technician, as he preferred to be called). When he burst into the cottage, he saw melee and tried to intervene. But as he raised his ax, Red Riding Hood and the wolf both stopped.

“And just what do you think you’re doing?” asked Red Riding Hood.

The woodchopper-person blinked and tried to answer, but no words came to him.

“Bursting in here like a Neanderthal, trusting your weapon to do your thinking for you!” she exclaimed. “Sexist! Speciesist! How dare you assume that womyn and wolves can’t solve their own problems without a man’s help!”

When she heard Red Riding Hood’s impassioned speech, Grandma jumped out of the wolf’s mouth, seized the woodchopper-person’s ax, and cut his head off. After this ordeal, Red Riding Hood, Grandma and the wolf felt a certain commonality of purpose. They decided to set up an alternative household based on mutual respect and cooperation, and they lived together in the woods happily ever after.

THE EMPEROR'S NEW CLOTHES

Far away, in a time long past, there lived a traveling tailor who found himself in an unfamiliar country. Now, tailors who move from place to place normally keep to themselves and are careful not to overstep the bounds of local decency. This tailor, though, was overly gregarious and decorum-impaired, and soon he was at a local inn, abusing alcohol, invading the personal space of the female employees, and telling unenlightened stories about tinkers, dung-gatherers, and other tradespeople.

The innkeeper complained to the police, who grabbed the tailor and dragged him in front of the emperor. As you might expect, a lifetime of belief in the absolute legitimacy of the monarchy and in the inherent superiority of males had turned the emperor into a vain and wisdom-challenged tyrant. The tailor noticed these traits and decided to use them to his advantage.

The emperor asked, "Do you have any last request before I banish you from my domain forever?"

The tailor replied, "Only that your majesty allow me the honor of crafting a new royal wardrobe. For I have brought with me a special fabric that is so rare and fine that it can be seen only by certain people – the type of people you'd want to have in *your* realm – people who are politically correct, morally righteous, intellectually astute, culturally tolerant, and who don't smoke, drink, laugh at sexist jokes, watch too much television, listen to country music, or barbecue. "

After a moment's thought, the emperor agreed to this request. He was flattered by the fascist and testosterone-heavy idea that the empire and its inhabitans existed only to make him look good. It would be like having a trophy wife and multiplying that feeling by 100,000.

Of course, no such rarefied fabric existed. Years of living outside the bounds of normal society had obliged the tailor to swindle and embarrass the emperor in the name of independent craftspeople everywhere. So, as he diligently labored, he was cutting and sewing pieces of fabric that, in the strictest objective sense of reality, didn't exist.

When the tailor announced that he was finished, the emperor looked at his new robes in the mirror. As he stood there, naked as the day he was born, one could see how years of exploiting the peasantry had turned his body into an ugly mass of puffy white flesh. The emperor, of course, saw this too, but pretended that he could see the beautiful, politically robes. To show off his new splendor, he ordered a parade to be held the next day.

On the following morning, his subjects lined the streets for the big parade. Word had spread about the emperor's new clothes that only enlightened people with healthy lifestyles could see, and everyone was determined to be more right-minded than his or her neighbor.

The parade began with great hoopla. As the emperor marched his pale, bloated, patriarchal carcass down the street, everyone loudly oohed and ahed at his beautiful new clothes. All except one small boy, who shouted:

"The emperor is naked!"

The parade stopped. The emperor paused. A hush fell over the crowd, until one quick-thinking peasant shouted:

"No, he isn't. The emperor is merely endorsing a clothing-optional lifestyle!"

A cheer went up from the crowd, and the throngs stripped off their clothes and danced in the sun, as Nature had intended. The country was clothing-optional from that day forward, and the tailor, deprived of any livelihood, packed up his needle and thread and was never heard from again.

THE THREE LITTLE PIGS

Once there were three little pigs who lived together in mutual respect and in harmony with their environment. Using materials that were indigenous to the area, they each built a beautiful house. One pig built a house of straw, one a house of sticks, and one a house of dung, clay, and creeper vines shaped into bricks and baked in a small kiln. When they were finished, the pigs were satisfied with their work and settled back to live in peace and self-determination.

But their idyll was soon shattered. One day, along came a big, bad wolf with expansionist ideas. He saw the pigs and grew very hungry, in both a physical and ideological sense. When the pigs saw the wolf, they ran into the house of

straw. The wolf ran up to the house and banged on the door, shouting, “Little pigs, little pigs, let me in!”

The pigs shouted back, “Your gunboat tactics hold no fear for pigs defending their homes and culture.”

But the wolf wasn’t to be denied what he thought was his manifest destiny. So he huffed and puffed and blew down the house of straw. The frightened pigs ran to the house of sticks, with the wolf in hot pursuit. Where the house of straw had stood, other wolves bought up the land and started a banana plantation.

At the house of sticks, the wolf again banged on the door and shouted, “Little pigs, little pigs, let me in!”

The pigs shouted back, “Go to hell, you carnivorous, imperialistic oppressor!”

At this, the wolf chuckled condescendingly. He thought to himself, “They are so childlike in their way. It will be a shame to see them go, but progress cannot be stopped.”

So the wolf huffed and puffed and blew down the house of sticks. The pigs ran to the house of bricks, with the wolf close at their heels. Where the house of sticks had stood, other wolves built a time-share condo resort complex for vacationing wolves, with each unit a fiberglass reconstruction of the house of sticks, as well as native curio shops, snorkeling, and dolphin shows.

At the house of bricks, the wolf again banged on the door and shouted, “Little pigs, little pigs, let me in!”

This time in response, the pigs sang songs of solidarity and wrote letters of protest to the United Nations.

By now the wolf was getting angry at the pigs’ refusal to see the situation from the carnivore’s point of view. So he huffed and puffed, and huffed and puffedm then grabbed his chest and fell over dead from a massive heart attack brought on from eating too many fatty meals.

The three little pigs rejoiced that justice had triumphed and did a little dance around the corpse of the wolf. Their next step was to liberate their homeland. They gathered together a band of other pigs who had been forced off their lands. This new brigade of *porcinistas* attacked the resort complex with machine guns and rocket launchers and slaughtered the cruel wolf oppressors, sending a clear signal to the rest of the hemisphere not to meddle in their internal affairs.

Then the pigs set up a model socialist democracy with free education, universal health care, and affordable housing for everyone.

Please note: The wolf in this story was a metaphorical construct. No actual wolves were harmed in the writing of this story.

THE THREE CODEPENDENT GOATS GRUFF

Once on a lovely mountainside lived three goats who were related as siblings. Their name was Gruff, and they were a very close family. During the winter months, they lived in a lush, green valley, eating grass and doing other things in a naturally goatish manner. When summer came, they would travel up the mountainside to where the pasture was sweeter. This way, they did not overgraze their valley and kept their ecological footprint as small as possible.

To get to this pasture, the goats had to cross a bridge over a wide chasm. When the first days of summer came, one goat set out to cross the bridge. This goat was the least chronologically accomplished of the siblings and thus had achieved the least superiority in size. When he reached the bridge, he lashed on his safety helmet and grasped the handrail. But as he began to cross, a menacing growl came from beneath the bridge.

Over the railing and onto the bridge leaped a troll – hairy, dirt accomplished, and odor-enhanced. “Yaaarrrgh!!” intoned the troll. “I am the keeper of this bridge, and while goats may have the right to cross it, I’ll eat any that try!”

“But why, Mr. Troll?” bleated the goat.

“Because I’m a troll, and proud of it. I have a troll’s needs, and those needs include eating goats, so you better respect them or else.”

The goat was frightened. “Certainly, sir,” he stammered. “If eating me would help you become a more complete troll, nothing would please me more. I but I really can’t commit myself to that course of action without first consulting my siblings. Will you excuse me?” And the goat ran back to the valley.

Next, the middle sibling goat came up to the bridge. This goat was more chronologically advanced than the first goat and so enjoyed an advantage in

size (although this did not make him a better or more deserving goat). He was about to cross the bridge when the troll stopped him.

“Nature has made me a troll,” he said, “and I embrace my trollhood. Would you deny me my right to live the life of a troll as fully and effectively and I can?”

“Me? Never?” exclaimed the goat proudly.

“Then stand still there while I come over and eat you up. And don’t try to run away; I would take that as a personal affront.” He began to invade the goat’s caprinal space.

“However,” blurted the goat, “I have a very close family, and it would be selfish of me to allow myself to be eaten without asking their opinion. I have respect for their feelings, too. I would hate to think that my absence would cause them any emotional stress, if I hadn’t first…”

“*Go* then!” screamed the troll.

“I’ll rush back here as soon as we reach a consensus,” the goat said, “for it’s not fair to keep you in suspense.”

“You’re too kind,” sighed the troll and the goat ran back to the valley. As his hunger grew, the troll began to feel a real grievance toward the goats. If he didn’t get to eat at least one of them, he was determined to go to the authorities.

When the third goat came to the bridge, the troll discovered that he was nearly twice the troll’s size, with large, sharp horns and hard, heavy hooves. The troll felt his physical-intimidation prerogative fading fast. As fear turned his insides to jelly, the troll sank to his knees and pleaded, “Oh, please, forgive me! I was using you and your goat siblings for my own selfish ends. I don’t know what drove me to it, but I’ve seen the error of my ways now.”

The goat, too, got on what may be passed for knees in goats and said, “Now, now, you can’t take all the blame for yourself. Our presence and supreme edibility put you in this situation. My siblings and I all feel terrible. Please, *you* must forgive *us*.”

The troll began to sob. “No, no, it’s all my fault. I threatened and bullied you all, just for the sake of my own survival. How selfish I was!”

But the goat would have none of this. “We were the selfish ones. We only wanted to save our skins, and we totally neglected your needs. Please, eat me now!”

“No,” said the troll, “you must butt me off this bridge for my insensitivity and selfishness.”

“I’ll do no such a thing,” said the goat, “since we all tempted you in the first place. Here, have a chomp. Go ahead.”

“I’m telling you,” the troll insisted, standing up, “I’m the guilty one here. Now knock me down this bridge and be quick about it!”

“Look”, said the goat, rearing to his full height, “no one is going to take away my blame for this, not even you, so eat me before I pop your nose.”

“Don’t play guiltier-than-thou with me, Hornhead!”

“’Hornhead’? You smelly hairball! I’ll show you guilt!” And with that, they wrestled and bit and punched and kicked as each sought to don the mantle of blame.

The other two goats bounded up to the bridge and sized up the fight. Feeling guilty at not accepting enough of blame, they joined the others in a whirling ball of hair, hooves, horns, and teeth. But the little bridge was not built to carry such weight. It shook and swayed and finally buckled, hurling the troll and the three codependent goats Gruff into the chasm. On their way down, they each felt relieved that they would finally get what they deserved, plus, as a bonus, a little extra guilt for the fate of others.

CINDERELLA

There once lived a young wommon named Cinderella, whose natural birthmother had died when Cinderella was but a child. A few years after, her father married a widow with two older daughters. Cinderella’s mother-of-step treated her very cruelly, and her sisters-of-step made her work very hard, as if she were their own personal unpaid laborer.

One day an invitation arrived at their house. The prince was celebrating his exploitation of the dispossessed and marginalized peasantry by throwing a fancy dress ball. Cinderella’s sisters-of-step were very excited to be invited to the palace. They began to plan the expensive clothes they would use to alter and enslave their natural body images to emulate an unrealistic standard of feminine beauty. (It was especially unrealistic in their case, as they were differently visaged to stop a clock.) Her mother-of-step also planned to go to the

ball so Cinderella was working harder than a dog (an appropriate if unfortunately speciesist metaphor).

When the day of the ball arrived, Cinderella helped her mother- and sisters-of-step into their ball gowns. A formidable task: It was like trying to force ten pounds of processed non-human animal carcasses into a five-pound skin. Next came an immense cosmetic augmentation, which it would be best not to describe at all. As evening fell, her mother- and sisters-of-step left Cinderella at home to finish her housework. Cinderella was sad, but she contented herself with her Holly Near records.

Suddenly there was a flash of light and in front of Cinderella stood a man dressed in loose-fitting, all-cotton clothes and wearing a wide-brimmed hat. At first Cinderella thought he was a Southern lawyer or a bandleader, but he soon put her straight.

“Hello, Cinderella, I am your fairy godperson, or individual deity proxy, if you prefer. So you want to go to the ball, eh? And bind yourself to the male concept of beauty? Squeeze into some tight-fitting dress that will cut off your circulation? Jam your feet into high-heeled shoes that will ruin your bone structure? Paint your face with chemicals and make-up that have been tested on nonhuman animals?”

“Oh yes, definitely,” she said in an instant. Her fairy godperson heaved a great sigh and decided to put off her political education till another day. With his magic, he enveloped her in a beautiful, bright light and whisked her away to the palace.

Many, many carriages were lined up outside the palace that night; apparently, no one had ever thought of carpooling. Soon, in a heavy, gilded carriage painfully pulled by a team of horse-slaves, Cinderella arrived. She was dressed in clinging gown woven of silk stolen from unsuspecting silkworms. Her hair was festooned with pearls plundered from hard-working, defenseless oysters. And one her feet, dangerous though it may seem, she wore slippers made of finely cut crystal.

Every head in the ballroom turned as Cinderella entered. The men stared at and lusted after wommon who had captured perfectly their Barbie-doll ideas of feminine desirability. The womyn, trained at an early age to despise their own

bodies, looked at Cinderella with envy and spite. Cinderella's own mother- and sisters-of-step, consumed with jealousy, failed to recognize her.

Cinderella soon caught the roving eye of the prince, who was busy discussing jousting and bear-baiting with his cronies. Upon seeing her, the prince was struck with a fit of not being able to speak as well as the majority of the population. "Here," he thought, "is a wommon that I could make my princess and impregnate with the progeny of our perfect genes, and thus make myself the envy of every prince for miles around. And she's blond, too!"

The prince began to cross the ballroom toward his intended prey. His cronies also began to walk toward Cinderella. So did every other male in the ballroom who was younger than 70 or not serving drinks.

Cinderella was proud of the commotion she was causing. She walked with head high and carried herself like a wommon of eminent social standing. But soon it became clear that the commotion was turning into something ugly, or at least socially dysfunctional.

The prince made it clear to his friends that he was intent on "possessing" the young wommon. But the prince's resoluteness angered his pals, for they too lusted after her and wanted to own her. The men began to shout and push each other. The prince's best friend, who was a large if cerebrally constrained duke, stopped him halfway across the dance floor and insisted that *he* was going to have Cinderella. The prince's response was a swift kick to the groin, which left the duke temporarily inactive. But the prince was quickly seized by other sex-crazed males, and he disappeared into a pile of human animals.

The womyn were appalled by this vicious display of testosterone, but try as they might, they were unable to separate the combatants. To the other womyn, it seemed that Cinderella was the cause of all the trouble, so they encircled her and began to display very unsisterly hostility. She tried to escape, but her impractical glass slippers made it nearly impossible. Fortunately for her, none of the other womyn were shod any better.

The noise grew so loud that no one heard the clock in the tower chime midnight. When the bell rang the twelfth time, Cinderella's beautiful gown and slippers disappeared, and she was dressed once again in her peasant's rags. Her mother- and sisters-of-step recognized her now, but kept quiet to avoid embarrassment.

The womyn grew silent at this magical transformation. Freed from the confinements of her gown and slippers, Cinderella sighed and scratched her ribs. She smiled, closed her eyes and said, “Kill me now if you want, sisters, but at least I’ll die in comfort.”

The womyn around her again grew envious, but this time they took a different approach: Instead of exacting vengeance on her, they stripped off their bodices, corsets, shoes, and every other confining garment. They danced and jumped and screeched in sheer joy, comfortable at last in their shifts and bare feet.

Had the men looked up from their macho dance of destruction, they would have seen many desirable womyn dressed as if for the boudoir. But they never ceased pounding, punching, kicking, and clawing each other until, to the last man, they were all dead. The womyn clucked their tongues but felt no remorse. The palace and the realm were theirs now. Their first official act was to dress the men in their discarded dresses and tell the media that the fight arose when someone threatened to expose the cross-dressing tendencies of the prince and his cronies. Their second was to set up a clothing co-op that produced only comfortable, practical clothes for womyn. Then they hung a sign on the castle advertising CinderWear (for that was what the new clothing was called), and through self-determination and clever marketing, they all – even the mother- and sisters-of-step – lived happily ever after.